



Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19)

Testing for COVID-19



Call your doctor: If you think you have been exposed to COVID-19 and develop a fever and symptoms, such as cough or difficulty breathing, call your healthcare provider for medical advice.

If you are a close contact of someone with COVID-19 or you are a resident in a community where there is ongoing spread of COVID-19 and develop [symptoms of COVID-19](#), call your healthcare provider and tell them about your symptoms and your exposure. They will decide whether you need to be tested, but keep in mind that there is no treatment for COVID-19 and people who are mildly ill may be able to isolate and care for themselves at home.

If you are at higher risk for serious illness

[People at higher risk for serious illness from COVID-19](#) should contact their healthcare provider early, even if their illness is mild.

Older adults and people who have severe underlying chronic medical conditions like heart or lung disease or diabetes seem to be at higher risk for developing more serious complications from COVID-19 illness.

If you are very sick get medical attention immediately

If you develop **emergency warning signs** for COVID-19 get **medical attention immediately**. Emergency warning signs include*:

- Difficulty breathing or shortness of breath
- Persistent pain or pressure in the chest
- New confusion or inability to arouse
- Bluish lips or face

*This list is not all inclusive. Please consult your medical provider for any other symptoms that are severe or concerning.

For healthcare professionals

For information on testing for healthcare professionals, see recommendations for reporting, testing, and specimen collection at [Interim Guidance for Healthcare Professionals](#).

Page last reviewed: March 13, 2020



Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19)



Coronavirus Self-Checker

There are laboratory tests that can identify the virus that causes COVID-19 in respiratory specimens. State and local public health departments have received tests from CDC while medical providers are getting tests developed by commercial manufacturers. All of these tests are Real-Time Reverse Transcriptase (RT)-PCR Diagnostic Panels, that can provide results in 4 to 6 hours.

Who should be tested

Not everyone needs to be tested for COVID-19. Here is some information that might help in making decisions about seeking care or testing.

- Most people have [mild illness](#) and are able to [recover at home](#).
- There is no treatment specifically approved for this virus.
- Testing results may be helpful to inform decision-making about who you come in contact with.

CDC has [guidance](#) for who should be tested, but **decisions about testing are at the discretion of state and local health departments and/or individual clinicians.**

- Clinicians should work with their state and local health departments to coordinate testing through public health laboratories, or work with clinical or commercial laboratories.

How to get tested

If you have symptoms of COVID-19 and want to get tested, try calling your state or local health department or a medical provider. While supplies of these tests are increasing, it may still be difficult to find a place to get tested.

What to do after you are tested

- If you test positive for COVID-19, see [If You Are Sick or Caring for Someone](#).
- If you test negative for COVID-19, you probably were not infected at the time your specimen was collected. However, that does not mean you will not get sick. It is possible that you were very early in your infection at the time of your specimen collection and that you could test positive later, or you could be exposed later and then develop illness. In other words, a negative test result does not rule out getting sick later.

[CDC expects that widespread transmission of COVID-19](#) in the United States will occur. In the coming months, most of the U.S. population will be exposed to this virus. You should continue to practice all the protective measures recommended to keep yourself and others free from illness. See [How to Protect Yourself](#).

Additional information: U.S. Food and Drug Administration [FAQs on Diagnostic Testing for SARS-CoV-2](#) .

If you are very sick get medical attention immediately

If you develop **emergency warning signs** for COVID-19 get **medical attention immediately**. Emergency warning signs include*:



- Trouble breathing
- Persistent pain or pressure in the chest
- New confusion or inability to arouse
- Bluish lips or face

*This list is not all inclusive. Please consult your medical provider for any other symptoms that are severe or concerning.

For healthcare professionals

For information on testing for healthcare professionals, see recommendations for reporting, testing, and specimen collection at [Interim Guidance for Healthcare Professionals](#).

Page last reviewed: March 21, 2020

Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19)

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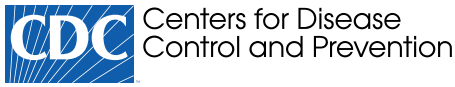


U.S. Department of Health & Human Services

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CDC Website Exit Disclaimer





Coronavirus Disease 2019

Testing for COVID-19



Self-Checker

A guide to help you make decisions and seek appropriate medical care

There are laboratory tests that can identify the virus that causes COVID-19 in respiratory specimens. State and local public health departments have received tests from CDC, whereas medical providers are getting tests developed by commercial manufacturers.

How to decide if you should be tested or seek care

Not everyone needs to be tested for COVID-19. Here is some information that might help you make decisions about seeking medical care or testing.

- Most people have [mild illness](#) and are able to [recover at home](#) without medical care. They may not need to be tested.
- There is no treatment specifically approved for people who have COVID-19.

CDC has [guidance](#) for who should be tested, but **decisions about testing are at the discretion of state and local health departments and/or individual clinicians.**

- Clinicians should work with their state and local health departments to coordinate testing through public health laboratories, or work with clinical or commercial laboratories.

How to get tested

COVID-19 testing differs by location. If you have symptoms of COVID-19 and want to get tested, call your medical provider first. You can also visit your [state](#) or [local](#) [health department's website](#) to look for the latest local information on testing. While supplies of these tests are increasing, it may still be difficult to find a place to get tested.

What to do after you are tested

- If you **test positive for COVID-19**, know what protective steps to take [If You Are Sick or Caring for Someone](#).
- If you **test negative for COVID-19**, you probably were not infected at the time your specimen was collected. However, that does not mean you will not get sick. It is possible that you were very early in your infection when your specimen was collected and that you could test positive later. Or you could be exposed later and then develop illness. In other words, a negative test result does not rule out getting sick later.

[Community transmission of COVID-19](#) is occurring in parts of the United States. In the coming months, most of the U.S. population will be exposed to this virus. You should continue to practice all the protective measures recommended to keep yourself and others from getting infected. See [How to Protect Yourself](#).

Additional information: U.S. Food and Drug Administration [FAQs on Diagnostic Testing for SARS-CoV-2](#) [link](#).

If you are very sick, get medical attention immediately

When to Seek Medical Attention

If you develop any of these **emergency warning signs*** for COVID-19 get **medical attention immediately**:

- Trouble breathing
- Persistent pain or pressure in the chest
- New confusion or inability to arouse
- Bluish lips or face

*This list is not all inclusive. Please consult your medical provider for any other symptoms that are severe or concerning to you.

Call 911 if you have a medical emergency: Notify the operator that you have, or think you might have, COVID-19. If possible, put on a cloth face covering before medical help arrives.

For healthcare professionals

For information on testing for healthcare professionals, see recommendations for reporting, testing, and specimen collection at [Interim Guidance for Healthcare Professionals](#).

Page last reviewed: April 15, 2020



Coronavirus Disease 2019

Testing for COVID-19

Two kinds of tests are available for COVID-19: [viral tests](#) and [antibody tests](#).

- A viral test tells you if you have a current infection.
- An antibody test tells you if you had a previous infection

An antibody test may not be able to show if you have a current infection, because it can take 1-3 weeks to make antibodies after symptoms occur. We do not know yet if having antibodies to the virus can protect someone from getting infected with the virus again, or how long that protection might last.

Who should be tested

To learn if you have a current infection, viral tests are used. But not everyone needs this test.

- Most people will have mild illness and can recover at home without medical care and may not need to be tested.
- CDC has [guidance](#) for who should be tested, but decisions about testing are made by [state](#) and [local](#) [health departments or healthcare providers](#).
- If you have symptoms of COVID-19 and want to get tested, call your healthcare provider first.
- You can also visit your state or local health department's website to look for the latest local information on testing.
- Although **supplies of tests are increasing**, it may still be difficult to find a place to get tested.

Results

- If you test positive for COVID-19 by a viral test, know what protective steps to take [if you are sick or caring for someone](#).
- If you test negative for COVID-19 by a viral test, you probably were not infected at the time your sample was collected. However, that does not mean you will not get sick. The test result only means that you did not have COVID-19 at the time of testing.

If you test positive or negative for COVID-19, no matter the type of test, you still should take preventive measures to [protect yourself and others](#).

For healthcare professionals

For information on evaluating and testing, see [recommendations for reporting, testing, and specimen collection](#)

For public health professionals

For information on antibody surveillance, see [objectives and types of surveys](#).

For laboratorians

For information on CDC viral and antibody testing, see information on [CDC lab tests](#).



Coronavirus Disease 2019

Testing for COVID-19

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An antibody test may not be able to show if you have a current infection, because it can take 1-3 weeks after infection to make antibodies. We do not know yet if having antibodies to the virus can protect someone from getting infected with the virus again, or how long that protection might last.

Who should be tested

To learn if you have a current infection, viral tests are used. But not everyone needs this test.

- Most people will have mild illness and can recover at home without medical care and may not need to be tested.
- CDC has [guidance](#) for who should be tested, but decisions about testing are made by [state](#) and [local](#) [health](#) departments or healthcare providers.
- If you have symptoms of COVID-19 and want to get tested, call your healthcare provider first.
- You can also visit your state or local health department's website to look for the latest local information on testing.
- Although **supplies of tests are increasing**, it may still be difficult to find a place to get tested.

Results

- If you test positive for COVID-19 by a viral test, know what protective steps to take [if you are sick or caring for someone](#).
- If you test negative for COVID-19 by a viral test, you probably were not infected at the time your sample was collected. However, that does not mean you will not get sick. The test result only means that you did not have COVID-19 at the time of testing.

If you test positive or negative for COVID-19, no matter the type of test, you still should take preventive measures to [protect yourself and others](#).

For healthcare professionals

For information on evaluating and testing, see [recommendations for reporting, testing, and specimen collection](#).

For public health professionals

For information on antibody surveillance, see [objectives and types of surveys](#).

For laboratorians

For information on CDC viral and antibody testing, see information on [CDC lab tests](#).



Coronavirus Disease 2019

Testing for COVID-19

Updated June 24, 2020

[Guidance on Interpreting COVID-19 Test Results](#)   : A guide for understanding test results and determining what actions to take.

Two kinds of tests are available for COVID-19: [viral tests](#) and [antibody tests](#).

- A viral test tells you if you have a current infection.
- An antibody test might tell you if you had a past infection. An antibody test might not show if you have a current infection because it can take 1–3 weeks after infection for your body to make antibodies. Having antibodies to the virus that causes COVID-19 might provide protection from getting infected with the virus again. If it does, we do not know how much protection the antibodies might provide or how long this protection might last.

If you test positive or negative for COVID-19 on a viral or an antibody test, **you still should take preventive measures to [protect yourself and others](#).**

How to get tested for current COVID-19 infection

- To learn if you have a current infection, [viral tests](#) are used. Most people have mild illness and can recover at home without medical care. Contact your healthcare provider if your symptoms are getting worse or if you have questions about your health.
- Decisions about testing are made by [state](#) and [local](#)  health departments or healthcare providers. You can visit your [state](#) or [local](#)  health department's website to look for the latest local information on testing.
- If you have symptoms of COVID-19 and want to get tested, call your healthcare provider first.
- If you have symptoms of COVID-19 and are not tested, it is important to stay home. Learn [what to do if you are sick](#).

More Information

[Healthcare Professionals](#)

[Public Health](#)

[Laboratorians](#)

[HHS Community Based Viral Testing Sites for COVID-19](#) 

[CDC: COVID-19 Frequently Asked Questions: Symptoms & Emergency Warning Signs](#)

[U.S. Food and Drug Administration: FAQs on Viral Testing for SARS-CoV-2](#) 



Coronavirus Disease 2019



COVID-19 Testing Overview

COVID-19 Testing Overview

Updated Aug. 24, 2020

[Find out who should get tested](#). Protect yourself and others. Wear a mask, wash hands often, stay 6 ft from others.

Two kinds of tests are available for COVID-19: viral tests and antibody tests.

- A [viral test](#) tells you if you have a current infection.
- An [antibody test](#) might tell you if you had a past infection.



Coronavirus Self-Checker

A guide to help you make decisions on when to seek testing and appropriate medical care.

Considerations for who should get tested

- People who have symptoms of COVID-19
- People who have had close contact (within 6 feet of an infected person for at least 15 minutes) with someone with confirmed COVID-19
- People who have been asked or referred to get testing by their healthcare provider, [local](#) [↗](#) or [state](#) health department

Not everyone needs to be tested. If you do get tested, you should self-quarantine/isolate at home pending test results and follow the advice of your health care provider or a public health professional.

How to get tested for current COVID-19 infection

- You can visit your [state](#) or [local](#) [↗](#) health department's website to look for the latest local information on testing.
- If you have symptoms of COVID-19 and want to get tested, call your healthcare provider first.

Results



Find out what steps you can take to prevent the spread of COVID-19

- If you test positive, know what protective steps to take to [prevent others from getting sick](#).
- If you test negative, you probably were not infected at the time your sample was collected. The test result only means that you did not have COVID-19 at the time of testing. Continue to take steps to [protect yourself](#).

Print Resources

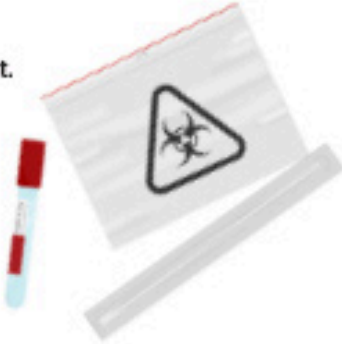
HOW TO COLLECT YOUR ANTERIOR NASAL SWAB SAMPLE FOR COVID-19 TESTING



Follow the instructions included with your sample kit. Use **only** materials provided in your kit to collect and store your sample, unless the kit says to do otherwise. Use **only** an approved sampling kit given to you by your healthcare provider or by personnel at the testing center.

Initial set-up

1. Open the sampling kit.



2. Apply hand sanitizer with at least 60% alcohol.

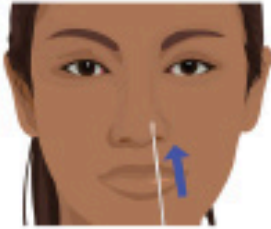


Sample collection

3. Remove the swab from the container, being careful not to touch the soft end with your hand.



4. Insert the swab into your nostril. Do not insert it more than half an inch into your nostril.



5. Slowly twist the swab, rubbing it along the insides of your nostril for 15 seconds.



 [PDF - 401 KB]

[How to Collect Your Anterior Nasal Swab Sample for COVID-19 Testing](#) 

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HOW TO COLLECT YOUR DEEP NASAL SWAB SAMPLE FOR COVID-19 TESTING



Follow the instructions included with your sample kit. Use **only** materials provided in your kit to collect and store your sample, unless the kit says to do otherwise. Use **only** an approved sampling kit given to you by your healthcare provider (if you are at home) or testing center personnel (if you are at a testing center).

Initial set-up

1. Open the sampling kit. Follow the kit instructions to label the sterile collection tube.



2. Wash your hands with soap and water for at least 20 seconds. If soap and water are not available, use hand sanitizer with at least 60% alcohol.



Sample collection

3. If gloves are included in the kit, put them on. Remove the swab from the container, being careful not to touch the soft end with your hands.



4. Tilt your head back as shown in this image.



5. Gently insert the swab deep into your nostril, parallel to the roof of your mouth until it can go no further – about 1 to 1½ inches.



[PDF - 420 KB]

Testing Deep Nasal Self Swab

What Your Test Results Mean

Accessible version available at <https://www.cdc.gov/coronavirus/2019-ncov/testing/diagnostic-testing.html>

If you test positive for COVID-19

TAKE STEPS TO HELP PREVENT THE SPREAD OF COVID-19



STAY HOME.

Do not leave your home, except to get medical care. Do not visit public areas.



STAY IN TOUCH WITH YOUR DOCTOR.



GET REST AND STAY HYDRATED.

Take over-the-counter medicines, such as acetaminophen, to help you feel better.



SEPARATE YOURSELF FROM OTHER PEOPLE.

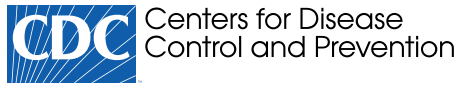
As much as possible, stay in a specific room and away from other people and pets in your home.

[PDF - PDF-215KB]

What Your Test Results Mean

Video Resources

Last Updated Aug. 24, 2020



Coronavirus Disease 2019



COVID-19 Testing Overview

Updated Oct. 21, 2020

[Find out who should get tested](#). Protect yourself and others. Wear a mask, wash hands often, stay 6 ft from others.

Two kinds of tests are available for COVID-19: viral tests and antibody tests.

- A [viral test](#) tells you if you have a current infection.
- An [antibody test](#) might tell you if you had a past infection.



Coronavirus Self-Checker

[Click Here to Begin](#)

Considerations for who should get tested

- People who have symptoms of COVID-19.
- People who have had [close contact](#) (within 6 feet for a total of 15 minutes or more) with someone with confirmed COVID-19.
- People who have been asked or referred to get testing by their healthcare provider, [local](#) [link](#) or [state](#) health department.

Not everyone needs to be tested. If you do get tested, you should self-quarantine/isolate at home pending test results and follow the advice of your health care provider or a public health professional.

How to get tested for current COVID-19 infection

- You can visit your [state](#) or [local](#) [link](#) health department's website to look for the latest local information on testing.
- If you have symptoms of COVID-19 and want to get tested, call your healthcare provider first.

Results



Find out what steps you can take to prevent the spread of COVID-19

- If you test positive, know what protective steps to take to prevent others from getting sick.
- If you test negative, you probably were not infected at the time your sample was collected. The test result only means that you did not have COVID-19 at the time of testing. Continue to take steps to protect yourself.

Print Resources

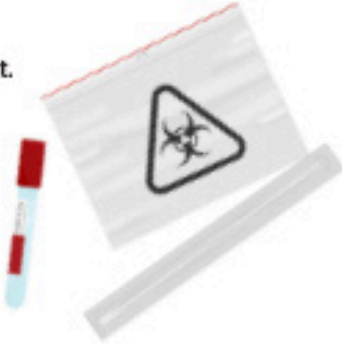
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Initial set-up

1. Open the sampling kit.



2. Apply hand sanitizer with at least 60% alcohol.

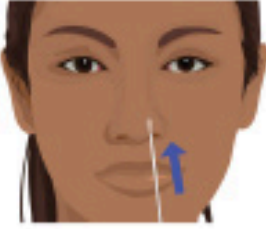


Sample collection

3. Remove the swab from the container, being careful not to touch the soft end with your hand.



4. Insert the swab into your nostril. Do not insert it more than half an inch into your nostril.



5. Slowly twist the swab, rubbing it along the insides of your nostril for 15 seconds.



 [PDF - 401 KB]

How to Collect Your Anterior Nasal Swab Sample for COVID-19 Testing



What Your Test Results Mean

Accessible version available at <https://www.cdc.gov/coronavirus/2019-ncov/testing/diagnostic-testing.html>

If you test positive for COVID-19

TAKE STEPS TO HELP PREVENT THE SPREAD OF COVID-19



STAY HOME.

Do not leave your home, except to get medical care. Do not visit public areas.



STAY IN TOUCH WITH YOUR DOCTOR.



GET REST AND STAY HYDRATED.

Take over-the-counter medicines, such as acetaminophen, to help you feel better.



SEPARATE YOURSELF FROM OTHER PEOPLE.

As much as possible, stay in a specific room and away from other people and pets in your home.

 [PDF - PDF-215KB]

[What Your Test Results Mean](#) 

Video Resources

Last Updated Oct. 21, 2020



COVID-19

 Cases are rising. Act now! Wear a mask; Stay 6 feet apart; Avoid crowds.

COVID-19 Testing Overview

Updated Dec. 7, 2020

[Find out who should get tested](#). Protect yourself and others. Wear a mask, wash hands often, stay 6 ft from others.

Two kinds of tests are available for COVID-19: viral tests and antibody tests.

- A [viral test](#) tells you if you have a current infection.
- An [antibody test](#) might tell you if you had a past infection.



Coronavirus Self-Checker

[Click Here to Begin](#)

Considerations for who should get tested

- People who have symptoms of COVID-19.
- People who have had [close contact](#) (within 6 feet for a total of 15 minutes or more) with someone with confirmed COVID-19.
- People who have taken part in activities that put them at higher risk for COVID-19 because they cannot socially distance as needed, such as travel, attending large social or mass gatherings, or being in crowded indoor settings.
- People who have been asked or referred to get testing by their healthcare provider, [local](#) [↗](#) or [state](#) health department.

Not everyone needs to be tested. If you do get tested, you should self-quarantine/isolate at home pending test results and follow the advice of your health care provider or a public health professional.

How to get tested for current COVID-19 infection

- You can visit your [state](#) or [local](#) [↗](#) health department's website to look for the latest local information on testing.
- If you have symptoms of COVID-19 and want to get tested, call your healthcare provider first.

Results



Find out what steps you can take to prevent the spread of COVID-19

- If you test positive, know what protective steps to take to [prevent others from getting sick](#).
- If you test negative, you probably were not infected at the time your sample was collected. The test result only means that you did not have COVID-19 at the time of testing. Continue to take steps to [protect yourself](#).

Print Resources

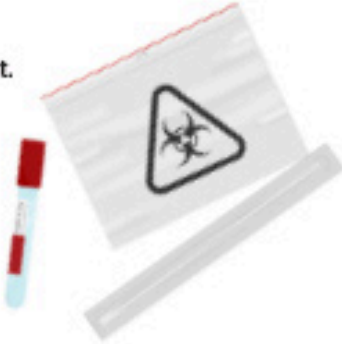
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Initial set-up

1. Open the sampling kit.



2. Apply hand sanitizer with at least 60% alcohol.



Sample collection

3. Remove the swab from the container, being careful not to touch the soft end with your hand.



4. Insert the swab into your nostril. Do not insert it more than half an inch into your nostril.



5. Slowly twist the swab, rubbing it along the insides of your nostril for 15 seconds.



How to Collect Your Anterior Nasal Swab Sample for COVID-19 Testing

English  [131 KB, 2 Pages] | Español  [131 KB, 2 Pages]

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What Your Test Results Mean

Accessible version available at <https://www.cdc.gov/coronavirus/2019-ncov/testing/diagnostic-testing.html>

If you test positive for COVID-19

TAKE STEPS TO HELP PREVENT THE SPREAD OF COVID-19



STAY HOME.

Do not leave your home, except to get medical care. Do not visit public areas.



STAY IN TOUCH WITH YOUR DOCTOR.



GET REST AND STAY HYDRATED.

Take over-the-counter medicines, such as acetaminophen, to help you feel better.



SEPARATE YOURSELF FROM OTHER PEOPLE.

As much as possible, stay in a specific room and away from other people and pets in your home.

What Your Test Results Mean

English [215 KB, 1 Page] | Español [213 KB, 1 página]

Video Resources

Last Updated Dec. 7, 2020

COVID-19

COVID-19 Testing Overview

Updated Mar. 17, 2021

[Find out who should get tested](#). Protect yourself and others. Wear a mask, stay at least 6 feet from others, avoid crowds and poorly ventilated indoor spaces, and wash your hands often.

Types of tests

COVID-19 tests are available that can test for [current infection](#) or [past infection](#).

- A [viral test](#) tells you if you have a current infection. Two types of viral tests can be used: nucleic acid amplification tests (NAATs) and antigen tests.
- An [antibody test](#) (also known as a serology test) might tell you if you had a past infection. Antibody tests should not be used to diagnose a current infection.



Coronavirus Self-Checker

[Click Here to Begin](#)

Who should get tested for current infection

- People who have [symptoms](#) of COVID-19.
- Most people who have had [close contact](#) (within 6 feet for a total of 15 minutes or more over a 24-hour period) with someone with confirmed COVID-19.
 - [Fully vaccinated](#) people with no COVID-19 symptoms do not need to be tested following an exposure to someone with COVID-19.
 - People who have tested positive for COVID-19 within the past 3 months and recovered do not need to get tested following an exposure as long as they do not develop new symptoms.
- Unvaccinated people who have taken part in activities that put them at higher risk for COVID-19 because they cannot physically distance as needed to avoid [exposure](#), such as travel, attending large social or mass gatherings, or being in crowded or poorly-ventilated indoor settings.
- People who have been asked or referred to get [tested](#) by their healthcare provider, or [state](#), [tribal](#), [local](#) [↗](#), or [territorial health department](#).

CDC recommends that anyone with any signs or [symptoms of COVID-19](#) get tested, regardless of vaccination status or prior infection. If you get tested because you have symptoms or were potentially exposed to the virus, you should stay away from others pending test results and follow the advice of your health care provider or a public health professional.

How to get tested for current COVID-19 infection

- Contact your healthcare provider or visit your [state](#), [tribal](#), [local](#) [link icon](#) , and territorial [health department's website](#) to find the latest local information on testing. The type of viral COVID-19 tests offered may differ by location.

You and your healthcare provider might also consider either an [at-home collection kit](#) or an [at-home test](#) if you have signs and symptoms of COVID-19 and if you can't get tested by a healthcare provider or public health official.

How to use results of viral tests



Find out what steps you can take to prevent the spread of COVID-19

- If you test **positive**, know what protective steps to take to [prevent others from getting sick](#).
- If you test **negative**, you probably were not infected at the time your sample was collected. The test result only means that you did not have COVID-19 at the time of testing. Continue to take steps to [protect yourself](#).

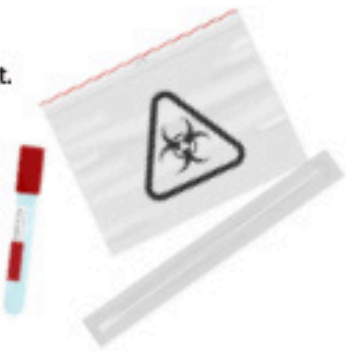
Print Resources

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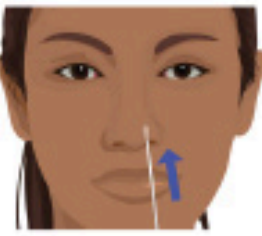


Sample collection

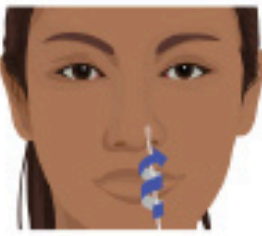
3. Remove the swab from the container, being careful not to touch the soft end with your hand.



4. Insert the swab into your nostril. Do not insert it more than half an inch into your nostril.



5. Slowly twist the swab, rubbing it along the insides of your nostril for 15 seconds.



How to Collect An Anterior Nasal Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing

CÓMO RECOLECTAR UNA MUESTRA DE LA REGIÓN NASAL ANTERIOR PARA LA PRUEBA DE COVID-19



Use **solamente** un kit de recolección de muestras autorizado, provisto por su proveedor de atención médica o el personal del lugar donde realicen las pruebas, o comprado sin receta en una farmacia u otra tienda. Siga las instrucciones incluidas en el kit de recolección de muestras que podría usarse en el sitio donde se hacen pruebas o en casa. Use **solamente** los materiales provistos en el kit de recolección y guarde o envíe por correo la muestra, a menos que las instrucciones digan otra cosa. Estas instrucciones también se pueden usar con los kits de pruebas caseras si especifican la recolección de la región nasal posterior con un bastoncito de algodón.

Preparación

1. Desinfecte la superficie sobre la que abrirá el kit de recolección. Retire el contenido del kit y póngalo sobre esa superficie. Lea las instrucciones antes de comenzar a recolectar la muestra.



2. Lávese las manos con agua y jabón. Si no hay agua y jabón disponibles, use un desinfectante de manos.

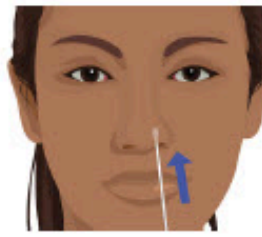


Recolección de la muestra

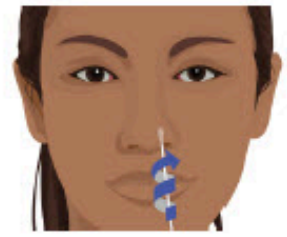
3. Retire el bastoncito de algodón del paquete. No toque el extremo blando con sus manos ni con otra cosa.



4. Inserte el extremo blando del bastoncito en una de sus fosas nasales, **no más de 3/4 de pulgada (1.5 cm)** dentro de la nariz.



5. Haga girar el bastoncito lentamente, presionando con suavidad contra la fosa nasal al menos 4 veces por un total de 15 segundos. Obtenga cuanto más pueda de las secreciones nasales en el extremo del bastoncito de algodón.



6. Retire el bastoncito suavemente.



7. Con el mismo bastoncito, repita los pasos 4 a 6 en la otra fosa nasal, usando el mismo extremo del bastoncito de algodón.



CS 317702-F MLS-322654 02/09/2021

cdc.gov/coronavirus-es

CÓMO RECOLECTAR UNA MUESTRA DE LA REGIÓN NASAL ANTERIOR PARA LA PRUEBA DE COVID-19

What Your Test Results Mean

What Your Test Results Mean

English [216kb, 1 page]

Español [208kb, 1 page]

How to Collect a Nasal Mid-Turbinate Swab Sample for COVID-19 Testing

How to Collect a Nasal Mid-Turbinate Swab Sample for COVID-19 Testing

CÓMO RECOGER UNA MUESTRA DEL CORNETE NASAL MEDIO PARA UNA PRUEBA DE COVID-19

CÓMO RECOGER UNA MUESTRA DEL CORNETE NASAL MEDIO PARA UNA PRUEBA DE COVID-19

Video Resources

Last Updated Mar. 17, 2021



COVID-19

UPDATE

Getting vaccinated prevents severe illness, hospitalizations, and death. Unvaccinated people should get vaccinated and continue masking until they are fully vaccinated. With the Delta variant, this is more urgent than ever. CDC has updated [guidance for fully vaccinated people](#) based on new evidence on the Delta variant.

COVID-19 Testing Overview

Updated July 2, 2021

[Find out who should get tested](#). Protect yourself and others. Wear a mask, stay at least 6 feet from others, avoid crowds and poorly ventilated indoor spaces, and wash your hands often.

Types of tests

COVID-19 tests are available that can test for [current infection](#) or [past infection](#).

- A [viral test](#) tells you if you have a current infection. Two types of viral tests can be used: nucleic acid amplification tests (NAATs) and antigen tests.
- An [antibody test](#) (also known as a serology test) might tell you if you had a past infection. Antibody tests should not be used to diagnose a current infection.



Coronavirus Self-Checker

[Click Here to Begin](#)

Who should get tested for current infection

- People who have [symptoms](#) of COVID-19.
- Most people who have had [close contact](#) (within 6 feet for a total of 15 minutes or more over a 24-hour period) with someone with confirmed COVID-19.
 - [Fully vaccinated](#) people with no COVID-19 symptoms do not need to be tested following an exposure to someone with COVID-19.
 - People who have tested positive for COVID-19 within the past 3 months and recovered do not need to get tested following an exposure as long as they do not develop new symptoms.
- Unvaccinated people who have taken part in activities that put them at higher risk for COVID-19 because they cannot physically distance as needed to avoid [exposure](#), such as travel, attending large social or mass gatherings, or being in crowded or poorly-ventilated indoor settings.

- People who have been asked or referred to get [tested](#) by their healthcare provider, or [state, tribal, local](#) [↗](#) , or [territorial health department](#).

CDC recommends that anyone with any signs or [symptoms of COVID-19](#) get tested, regardless of vaccination status or prior infection. If you get tested because you have symptoms or were potentially exposed to the virus, you should stay away from others pending test results and follow the advice of your health care provider or a public health professional.

When you are fully vaccinated and traveling internationally

Before arriving in the United States, you are [required to get tested](#) 3 days before travel by air (or show documentation of recovery from COVID-19 in the past 3 months) and get tested 3-5 days after your trip.

How to get tested for current COVID-19 infection

- Contact your healthcare provider or visit your [state, tribal, local](#) [↗](#) , and territorial [health department's website](#) to find the latest local information on testing. The type of viral COVID-19 tests offered may differ by location.

You and your healthcare provider might also consider either an [at-home collection kit](#) or an [at-home test](#) if you have signs and symptoms of COVID-19 and if you can't get tested by a healthcare provider or public health official.

How to use results of viral tests



Find out what steps you can take to prevent the spread of COVID-19

- **If you test positive**, know what protective steps to take to [prevent others from getting sick](#).
- **If you test negative**, you probably were not infected at the time your sample was collected. The test result only means that you did not have COVID-19 at the time of testing. Continue to take steps to [protect yourself](#).

Print Resources

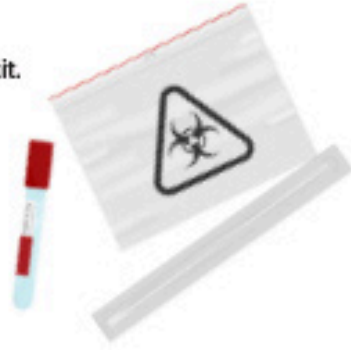
HOW TO COLLECT YOUR ANTERIOR NASAL SWAB SAMPLE FOR COVID-19 TESTING



Follow the instructions included with your sample kit. Use **only** materials provided in your kit to collect and store your sample, unless the kit says to do otherwise. Use **only** an approved sampling kit given to you by your healthcare provider or by personnel at the testing center.

Initial set-up

1. Open the sampling kit.



2. Apply hand sanitizer with at least 60% alcohol.



Sample collection

3. Remove the swab from the container, being careful not to touch the soft end with your hand.



4. Insert the swab into your nostril. Do not insert it more than half an inch into your nostril.



5. Slowly twist the swab, rubbing it along the insides of your nostril for 15 seconds.



How to Collect An Anterior Nasal Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing

CÓMO RECOLECTAR UNA MUESTRA DE LA REGIÓN NASAL ANTERIOR PARA LA PRUEBA DE COVID-19



Use **solamente** un kit de recolección de muestras autorizado, provisto por su proveedor de atención médica o el personal del lugar donde realicen las pruebas, o comprado sin receta en una farmacia u otra tienda. Siga las instrucciones incluidas en el kit de recolección de muestras que podría usarse en el sitio donde se hacen pruebas o en casa. Use **solamente** los materiales provistos en el kit de recolección y guarde o envíe por correo la muestra, a menos que las instrucciones digan otra cosa. Estas instrucciones también se pueden usar con los kits de pruebas caseras si especifican la recolección de la región nasal posterior con un bastoncito de algodón.

Preparación

1. Desinfecte la superficie sobre la que abrirá el kit de recolección. Retire el contenido del kit y póngalo sobre esa superficie. Lea las instrucciones antes de comenzar a recolectar la muestra.



2. Lávese las manos con agua y jabón. Si no hay agua y jabón disponibles, use un desinfectante de manos.

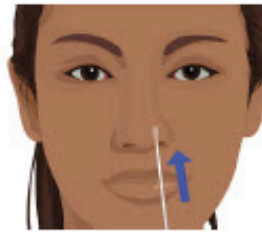


Recolección de la muestra

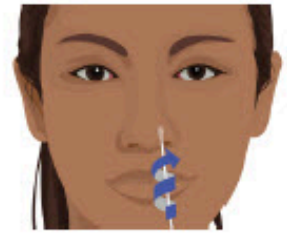
3. Retire el bastoncito de algodón del paquete. No toque el extremo blando con sus manos ni con otra cosa.



4. Inserte el extremo blando del bastoncito en una de sus fosas nasales, **no más de 3/4 de pulgada (1.5 cm)** dentro de la nariz.



5. Haga girar el bastoncito lentamente, presionando con suavidad contra la fosa nasal al menos 4 veces por un total de 15 segundos. Obtenga cuanto más pueda de las secreciones nasales en el extremo del bastoncito de algodón.



6. Retire el bastoncito suavemente.



7. Con el mismo bastoncito, repita los pasos 4 a 6 en la otra fosa nasal, usando el mismo extremo del bastoncito de algodón.



CS317702-F MLS-322654 02/09/2021

cdc.gov/coronavirus-es

CÓMO RECOLECTAR UNA MUESTRA DE LA REGIÓN NASAL ANTERIOR PARA LA PRUEBA DE COVID-19

What Your Test Results Mean

Accessible version available at <https://www.cdc.gov/coronavirus/2019-ncov/testing/diagnostic-testing.html>

If you test positive for COVID-19

TAKE STEPS TO HELP PREVENT THE SPREAD OF COVID-19



STAY HOME.

Do not leave your home, except to get medical care. Do not visit public areas.



STAY IN TOUCH WITH YOUR DOCTOR.



GET REST AND STAY HYDRATED.

Take over-the-counter medicines, such as acetaminophen, to help you feel better.



SEPARATE YOURSELF FROM OTHER PEOPLE.

As much as possible, stay in a specific room and away from other people and pets in your home.

HOW TO COLLECT A NASAL MID-TURBINATE SPECIMEN FOR COVID-19 TESTING



Use **only** an authorized specimen collection kit. Get a kit from your healthcare provider or a testing center. Kits are available at a pharmacy or other retail outlet. Follow the instructions included with the specimen collection kit. Use **only** materials provided in the kit to collect and store or mail the specimen unless the kit says to do otherwise. Use these instructions with kits that specify a nasal mid-turbinate swab collection.

Setup

1. Disinfect the surface where you will open the collection kit. Remove and lay out contents of kit. Read instructions before starting specimen collection.



2. Wash hands with soap and water. If soap and water are not available, use hand sanitizer.

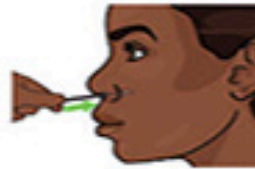


Specimen Collection

3. Remove the swab from the package. Do not touch the soft end with your hands or anything else.



4. Insert the entire soft end of the swab straight back into your nostril **less than one inch** (about 2cm) or until resistance is felt.



5. Slowly rotate the swab, gently rubbing it along the insides of your nasal passage several times.



6. Gently remove the swab.



7. Using the same swab, repeat steps 4-6 in your other nostril with the same end of the swab.



How to Collect a Nasal Mid-Turbinate Swab Sample for COVID-19 Testing

CÓMO RECOGER UNA MUESTRA DEL CORNETE NASAL MEDIO PARA UNA PRUEBA DE COVID-19



Use **solamente** un kit de recolección de muestras autorizado. Obtenga un kit de su proveedor de atención médica o del centro donde realicen las pruebas de detección. Los kits están disponibles en farmacias u otros almacenes. Siga las instrucciones incluidas en el kit de recolección de muestras. Use **solamente** los materiales provistos en el kit de recolección y guarde o envíe por correo la muestra a menos que las instrucciones digan otra cosa. Use estas instrucciones con los kits que especifiquen la recolección de muestra del cornete nasal medio con un bastoncito de algodón (hisopo).

Preparación

1. Desinfecte la superficie sobre la que abrirá el kit de recolección. Retire el contenido del kit y póngalo sobre esa superficie. Lea las instrucciones antes de comenzar a recolectar la muestra.



2. Lávese las manos con agua y jabón. Si no hay agua y jabón disponibles, use un desinfectante de manos.

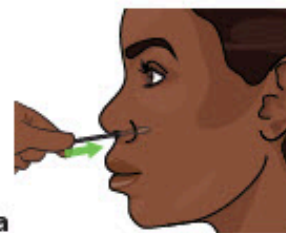


Recolección de muestra

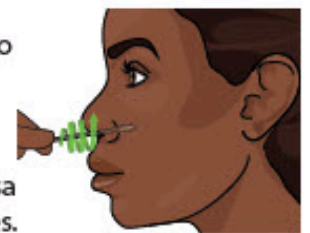
3. Retire el bastoncito de algodón del paquete. No toque el extremo blando con sus manos ni con otra cosa.



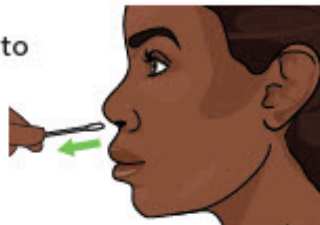
4. Inserte el extremo blando (algodón) del bastoncito hacia la parte de atrás de una de sus fosas nasales, **menos de una pulgada** (alrededor de 2 cm) o hasta que sienta resistencia (sienta que algo no lo deja seguir).



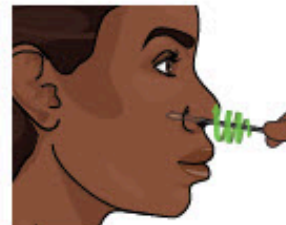
5. Gire el bastoncito lentamente, frotándolo con suavidad por el interior de su fosa nasal varias veces.



6. Retire el bastoncito suavemente.



7. Con el mismo bastoncito, repita los pasos 4 a 6 en la otra fosa nasal, usando el mismo extremo del bastoncito de algodón.



[cdc.gov/coronavirus-es](https://www.cdc.gov/coronavirus-es)

CÓMO RECOGER UNA MUESTRA DEL CORNETE NASAL MEDIO PARA UNA PRUEBA DE COVID-19

Video Resources

Last Updated July 2, 2021



COVID-19

To maximize protection from the [Delta variant](#) and prevent possibly spreading it to others, get vaccinated as soon as you can and wear a mask indoors in public if you are in [an area of substantial or high transmission](#).

Updated Aug. 2, 2021 [Languages](#) ▼

[Find out who should get tested](#). Protect yourself and others. Wear a mask, stay at least 6 feet from others, avoid crowds and poorly ventilated indoor spaces, and wash your hands often.

Types of tests

COVID-19 tests are available that can test for [current infection](#) or [past infection](#).

- A [viral test](#) tells you if you have a current infection. Two types of viral tests can be used: nucleic acid amplification tests (NAATs) and antigen tests.
- An [antibody test](#) (also known as a serology test) might tell you if you had a past infection. Antibody tests should not be used to diagnose a current infection.



Coronavirus Self-Checker

[Click Here to Begin](#)

Who should get tested for current infection

- People who have [symptoms](#) of COVID-19.
- Most people who have had [close contact](#) (within 6 feet for a total of 15 minutes or more over a 24-hour period) with someone with confirmed COVID-19.
 - Fully vaccinated people should be tested 3-5 days following a known exposure to someone with suspected or confirmed COVID-19 and wear a mask in public indoor settings for 14 days or until they receive a negative test result.
 - People who have tested positive for COVID-19 within the past 3 months and recovered do not need to get tested following an exposure as long as they do not develop new symptoms.
- Unvaccinated people who have taken part in activities that put them at higher risk for COVID-19 because they cannot physically distance as needed to avoid [exposure](#), such as travel, attending large social or mass gatherings, or being in crowded or poorly-ventilated indoor settings.
- People who have been asked or referred to get [tested](#) by their healthcare provider, or [state](#), [tribal](#), [local](#) [link icon](#), or [territorial health department](#).

CDC recommends that anyone with any signs or [symptoms of COVID-19](#) get tested, regardless of vaccination status or prior infection. If you get tested because you have symptoms or were potentially exposed to the virus, you should stay away from others pending test results and follow the advice of your health care provider or a public health professional.

When you are fully vaccinated and traveling internationally

International travelers need to pay close attention to the situation at their international destinations before traveling due to the spread of new variants and because the burden of COVID-19 varies globally.

- Fully vaccinated travelers do not need to get tested before leaving the United States unless required by their destination.
- Fully vaccinated air travelers coming to the United States from abroad, including U.S. citizens, are still [required](#) to have a negative SARS-CoV-2 viral test result or documentation of recovery from COVID-19 before they board a flight to the United States.
- International travelers arriving in the United States are still recommended to get a SARS-CoV-2 viral test 3-5 days after travel regardless of vaccination status.
- Fully vaccinated travelers do not need to self-quarantine in the United States following international travel.
- For more information, see [International Travel During COVID-19](#).

How to get tested for current COVID-19 infection

- Contact your healthcare provider or visit your [state](#), [tribal](#), [local](#) [↗](#) , and territorial [health department's website](#) to find the latest local information on testing. The type of viral COVID-19 tests offered may differ by location.

You and your healthcare provider might also consider either an [at-home collection kit or an at-home test](#) if you have signs and symptoms of COVID-19 and if you can't get tested by a healthcare provider or public health official.

How to use results of viral tests



Find out what steps you can take to prevent the spread of COVID-19

- **If you test positive**, know what protective steps to take to [prevent others from getting sick](#).
- **If you test negative**, you probably were not infected at the time your sample was collected. The test result only means that you did not have COVID-19 at the time of testing. Continue to take steps to [protect yourself](#).

Print Resources

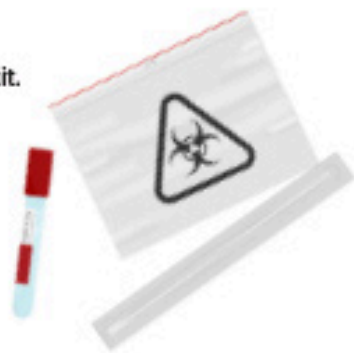
HOW TO COLLECT YOUR ANTERIOR NASAL SWAB SAMPLE FOR COVID-19 TESTING



Follow the instructions included with your sample kit. Use **only** materials provided in your kit to collect and store your sample, unless the kit says to do otherwise. Use **only** an approved sampling kit given to you by your healthcare provider or by personnel at the testing center.

Initial set-up

1. Open the sampling kit.



2. Apply hand sanitizer with at least 60% alcohol.



Sample collection

3. Remove the swab from the container, being careful not to touch the soft end with your hand.



4. Insert the swab into your nostril. Do not insert it more than half an inch into your nostril.



5. Slowly twist the swab, rubbing it along the insides of your nostril for 15 seconds.



How to Collect An Anterior Nasal Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing

[English](#) [371KB, 2 Pages]

[Español](#) [371KB, 2 Pages]

What Your Test Results Mean

Accessible version available at <https://www.cdc.gov/coronavirus/2019-ncov/testing/diagnostic-testing.html>

If you test positive for COVID-19

TAKE STEPS TO HELP PREVENT THE SPREAD OF COVID-19



STAY HOME.

Do not leave your home, except to get medical care. Do not visit public areas.



STAY IN TOUCH WITH YOUR DOCTOR.



GET REST AND STAY HYDRATED.

Take over-the-counter medicines, such as acetaminophen, to help you feel better.



SEPARATE YOURSELF FROM OTHER PEOPLE.

As much as possible, stay in a specific room and away from other people and pets in your home.

What Your Test Results Mean

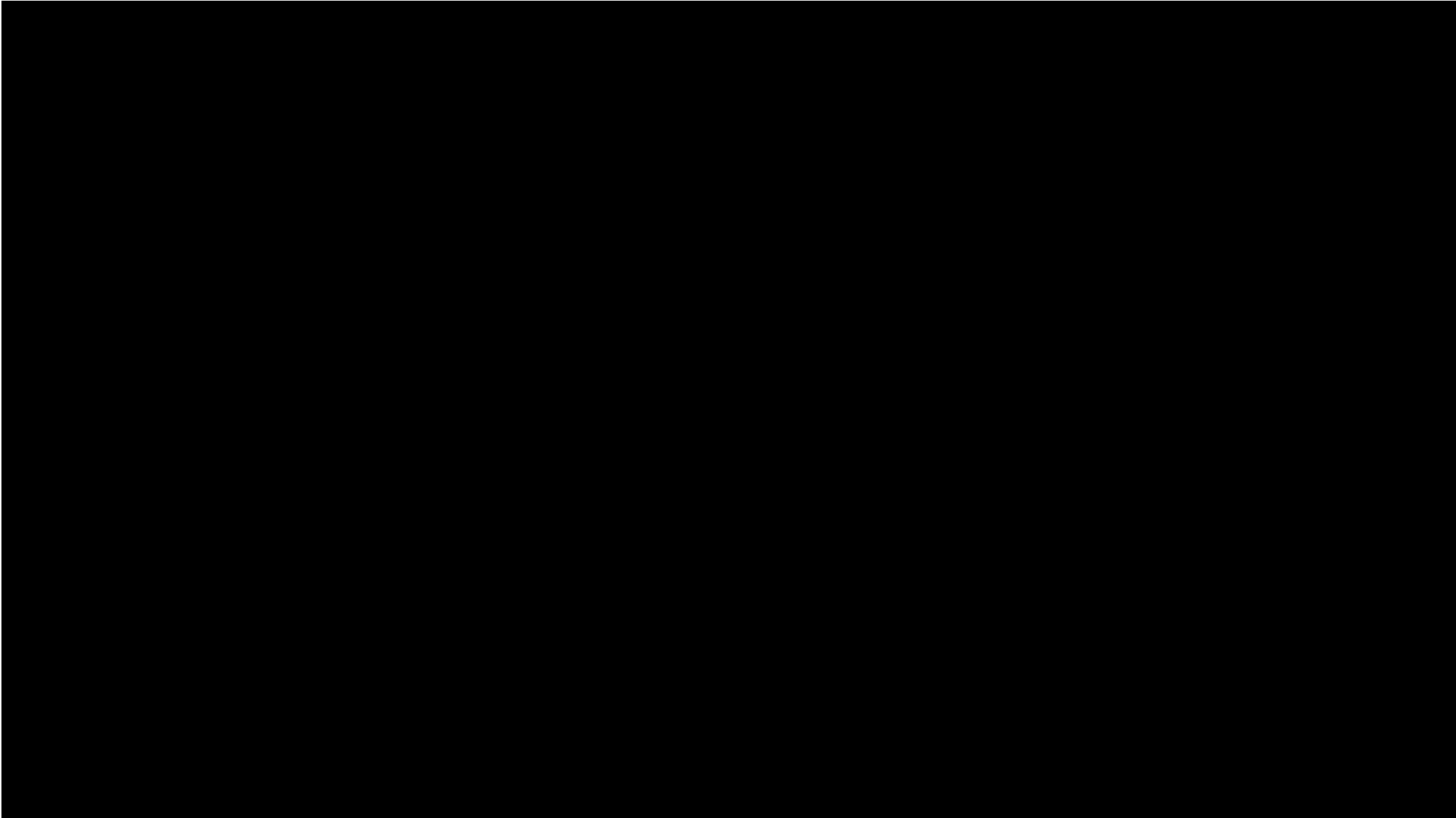
[English](#) [216kb, 1 page]

[Español](#) [208kb, 1 page]

How to Collect a Nasal Mid-Turbinate Swab Sample for COVID-19 Testing

How to Collect a Nasal Mid-Turbinate Swab Sample for COVID-19 Testing

Video Resources



 [Low Resolution Video](#) 



Last Updated Aug. 2, 2021

 Your Health

About COVID-19	+
Variants of the Virus	+
Symptoms	+
Testing	+
Prevent Getting Sick	+
If You Are Sick	+
Different Groups of People	+
Activities, Gatherings & Holidays	+
Travel	+
Archive	

 Get Email Updates

To receive email updates about COVID-19, enter your email address:

Email Address

[What's this?](#)

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U.S. Department of Health & Human Services
USA.gov



COVID-19

COVID-19 Testing Overview

Updated Oct. 21, 2021

[Find out who should get tested.](#) Protect yourself and others. Wear a mask, stay at least 6 feet from others, avoid crowds and poorly ventilated indoor spaces, and wash your hands often.

Types of tests

COVID-19 tests are available that can test for [current infection](#) or [past infection](#).

- A [viral test](#) tells you if you have a current infection. Two types of viral tests can be used: nucleic acid amplification tests (NAATs) and antigen tests.
- An [antibody test](#) (also known as a serology test) might tell you if you had a past infection. Antibody tests should not be used to diagnose a current infection.



Coronavirus Self-Checker

A tool to help you make decisions on when to seek testing and medical care.

[Get Started](#)[About the Tool](#)

Who should get tested for current infection

- People who have [symptoms](#) of COVID-19.
- Most people who have had [close contact](#) (within 6 feet for a total of 15 minutes or more over a 24-hour period) with someone with confirmed COVID-19.
 - Fully vaccinated people should be tested 5-7 days following a known exposure to someone with suspected or confirmed COVID-19 and wear a mask in public indoor settings for 14 days or until they receive a negative test result.

- People who have tested positive for COVID-19 within the past 3 months and recovered do not need to get tested following an exposure as long as they do not develop new symptoms.

- Unvaccinated people who have taken part in activities that put them at higher risk for COVID-19 because they cannot physically distance as needed to avoid [exposure](#), such as travel, attending large social or mass gatherings, or being in crowded or poorly-ventilated indoor settings.
- People who have been asked or referred to get [tested](#) by their healthcare provider, or [state](#), [tribal](#), [local](#) [link icon](#), or [territorial health department](#).

CDC recommends that anyone with any signs or [symptoms of COVID-19](#) get tested, regardless of vaccination status or prior infection. If you get tested because you have symptoms or were potentially exposed to the virus, you should stay away from others pending test results and follow the advice of your health care provider or a public health professional.

When you are fully vaccinated and traveling internationally

International travelers need to pay close attention to the situation at their international destinations before traveling due to the spread of new variants and because the burden of COVID-19 varies globally.

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- Fully vaccinated air travelers coming to the United States from abroad, including U.S. citizens, are still [required](#) to have a negative SARS-CoV-2 viral test result or documentation of recovery from COVID-19 before they board a flight to the United States.
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How to get tested for current COVID-19 infection

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How to use results of viral tests



Find out what steps you can take to prevent the spread of COVID-19

- If you test positive, know what protective steps to take to [prevent others from getting sick](#).
- If you test negative, you probably were not infected at the time your sample was collected. The test result only means that you did not have COVID-19 at the time of testing. Continue to take steps to [protect yourself](#).

Print Resources

HOW TO COLLECT YOUR ANTERIOR NASAL SWAB SAMPLE FOR COVID-19 TESTING



Follow the instructions included with your sample kit. Use **only** materials provided in your kit to collect and store your sample, unless the kit says to do otherwise. Use **only** an approved sampling kit given to you by your healthcare provider or by personnel at the testing center.

Initial set-up

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2. Apply hand sanitizer with at least 60% alcohol.



Sample collection

3. Remove the swab from the container, being careful not to touch the soft end with your hand.



4. Insert the swab into your nostril. Do not insert it more than half an inch into your nostril.



5. Slowly twist the swab, rubbing it along the insides of your nostril for 15 seconds.



How to Collect An Anterior Nasal Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing

English  [371KB, 2 Pages]

Español  [371KB, 2 Pages]

What Your Test Results Mean

Accessible version available at <https://www.cdc.gov/coronavirus/2019-ncov/testing/diagnostic-testing.html>

If you test positive for COVID-19

TAKE STEPS TO HELP PREVENT THE SPREAD OF COVID-19



STAY HOME.

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Take over-the-counter medicines, such as acetaminophen, to help you feel better.



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As much as possible, stay in a specific room and away from other people and pets in your home.

What Your Test Results Mean

English  [216kb, 1 page]

Español  [208kb, 1 page]

HOW TO COLLECT A NASAL MID-TURBINATE SPECIMEN FOR COVID-19 TESTING



Use **only** an authorized specimen collection kit. Get a kit from your healthcare provider or a testing center. Kits are available at a pharmacy or other retail outlet. Follow the instructions included with the specimen collection kit. Use **only** materials provided in the kit to collect and store or mail the specimen unless the kit says to do otherwise. Use these instructions with kits that specify a nasal mid-turbinate swab collection.

Setup

1. Disinfect the surface where you will open the collection kit. Remove and lay out contents of kit. Read instructions before starting specimen collection.



2. Wash hands with soap and water. If soap and water are not available, use hand sanitizer.



Specimen Collection

3. Remove the swab from the package. Do not touch the soft end with your hands or anything else.



4. Insert the entire soft end of the swab straight back into your nostril **less than one inch** (about 2cm) or until resistance is felt.



5. Slowly rotate the swab, gently rubbing it along the insides of your nasal passage several times.



6. Gently remove the swab.



7. Using the same swab, repeat steps 4-6 in your other nostril with the same end of the swab.



How to Collect a Nasal Mid-Turbinate Swab Sample for COVID-19 Testing

English [3.51MB, 2 Pages]

Español [3.51MB, 2 Pages]

3 Key Steps to Take While Waiting for Your COVID-19 Test Result

To help stop the spread of COVID-19, take these **3 key steps NOW** while waiting for your test results:

1 Stay home and monitor your health.

Stay home and monitor your health to help protect your friends, family, and others from possibly getting COVID-19 from you.

Stay home and away from others:

- If possible, stay away from others, especially people who are at higher risk for getting very sick from COVID-19, such as older adults and people with other medical conditions.
- If you have been in [contact](#) with someone with COVID-19, stay home and away from others for 14 days after your last [contact](#) with that person.



Monitor your health:

- Watch for fever, cough, shortness of breath, or other symptoms of COVID-19. Remember, symptoms may appear 2-14 days after exposure to COVID-19 and can include:
 - Fever or chills
 - Cough
 - Shortness of breath
 - New loss of taste or smell
 - Sore throat



3 key steps to take while waiting for your COVID-19 test results

English  [229KB, 2 Pages]

Español  [232KB, 2 Pages]

Last Updated Oct. 21, 2021



COVID-19

COVID-19 Testing Overview

Updated Oct. 27, 2021

[Find out who should get tested](#). Protect yourself and others. Wear a mask, stay at least 6 feet from others, avoid crowds and poorly ventilated indoor spaces, and wash your hands often.

Types of tests

COVID-19 tests are available that can test for [current infection](#) or [past infection](#).

- A [viral test](#) tells you if you have a current infection. Two types of viral tests can be used: nucleic acid amplification tests (NAATs) and antigen tests.
- An [antibody test](#) (also known as a serology test) might tell you if you had a past infection. Antibody tests should not be used to diagnose a current infection.



Coronavirus Self-Checker

A tool to help you make decisions on when to seek testing and medical care.

[Get Started](#)

[About the Tool](#)

Who should get tested for current infection

- People who have [symptoms](#) of COVID-19.
- People who have come into [close contact](#) with someone with COVID-19 should be tested to check for infection:
 - [Fully vaccinated](#) people should be tested 5–7 days after their last exposure.
 - People who are not fully vaccinated should get tested immediately when they find out they are a close contact. If their test result is negative, they should get tested again 5–7 days after their last exposure or immediately if symptoms develop.
- Unvaccinated people who have taken part in activities that put them at higher risk for COVID-19 because they cannot physically distance as needed to avoid [exposure](#), such as travel, attending large social or mass gatherings, or being in crowded or poorly-ventilated indoor settings.
- People who have been asked or referred to get [tested](#) by their healthcare provider, or [state](#), [tribal](#), [local](#) [link icon](#), or [territorial health department](#).

CDC recommends that anyone with any signs or [symptoms of COVID-19](#) get tested, regardless of vaccination status or prior infection. If you get tested because you have symptoms or were potentially exposed to the virus, you should stay away from others pending test results and follow the advice of your health care provider or a public health professional.

When you are fully vaccinated and traveling internationally

International travelers need to pay close attention to the situation at their international destinations before traveling due to the spread of new variants and because the burden of COVID-19 varies globally.

- Fully vaccinated travelers do not need to get tested before leaving the United States unless required by their destination.
- Fully vaccinated air travelers coming to the United States from abroad, including U.S. citizens, are still [required](#) to have a negative SARS-CoV-2 viral test result or documentation of recovery from COVID-19 before they board a flight to the United States.
- International travelers arriving in the United States are still recommended to get a SARS-CoV-2 viral test 3-5 days after travel regardless of vaccination status.
- Fully vaccinated travelers do not need to self-quarantine in the United States following international travel.
- For more information, see [International Travel During COVID-19](#).

How to get tested for current COVID-19 infection

- Contact your healthcare provider or visit your [state](#), [tribal](#), [local](#) [link icon](#) , and territorial [health department's website](#) to find the latest local information on testing. The type of viral COVID-19 tests offered may differ by location.

You and your healthcare provider might also consider either an [at-home collection kit](#) or an [at-home test](#) if you have signs and symptoms of COVID-19 and if you can't get tested by a healthcare provider or public health official.

How to use results of viral tests



Find out what steps you can take to prevent the spread of COVID-19

- **If you test positive**, know what protective steps to take to [prevent others from getting sick](#).
- **If you test negative**, you probably were not infected at the time your sample was collected. The test result only means that you did not have COVID-19 at the time of testing. Continue to take steps to [protect yourself](#).

Print Resources

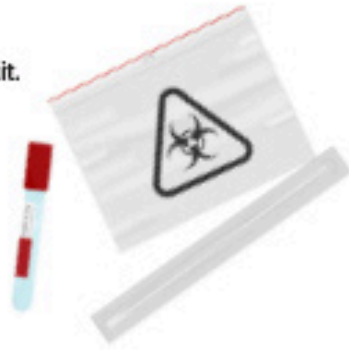
HOW TO COLLECT YOUR ANTERIOR NASAL SWAB SAMPLE FOR COVID-19 TESTING



Follow the instructions included with your sample kit. Use **only** materials provided in your kit to collect and store your sample, unless the kit says to do otherwise. Use **only** an approved sampling kit given to you by your healthcare provider or by personnel at the testing center.

Initial set-up

1. Open the sampling kit.



2. Apply hand sanitizer with at least 60% alcohol.



Sample collection

3. Remove the swab from the container, being careful not to touch the soft end with your hand.



4. Insert the swab into your nostril. Do not insert it more than half an inch into your nostril.



5. Slowly twist the swab, rubbing it along the insides of your nostril for 15 seconds.



How to Collect An Anterior Nasal Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing

English [371KB, 2 Pages]

Español [371KB, 2 Pages]

What Your Test Results Mean

Accessible version available at <https://www.cdc.gov/coronavirus/2019-ncov/testing/diagnostic-testing.html>

If you test positive for COVID-19

TAKE STEPS TO HELP PREVENT THE SPREAD OF COVID-19



STAY HOME.

Do not leave your home, except to get medical care. Do not visit public areas.



STAY IN TOUCH WITH YOUR DOCTOR.



GET REST AND STAY HYDRATED.

Take over-the-counter medicines, such as acetaminophen, to help you feel better.



SEPARATE YOURSELF FROM OTHER PEOPLE.

As much as possible, stay in a specific room and away from other people and pets in your home.

What Your Test Results Mean

English [216kb, 1 page]

Español [208kb, 1 page]

HOW TO COLLECT A NASAL MID-TURBINATE SPECIMEN FOR COVID-19 TESTING



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Setup

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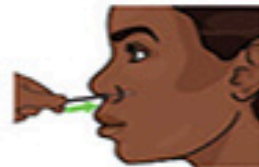


Specimen Collection

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How to Collect a Nasal Mid-Turbinate Swab Sample for COVID-19 Testing

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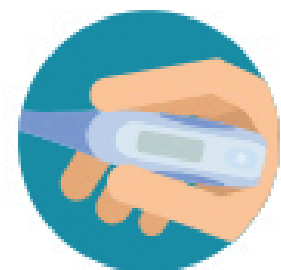
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3 key steps to take while waiting for your COVID-19 test results

English [229KB, 2 Pages]

Español [232KB, 2 Pages]



COVID-19

Updated Dec. 6, 2021 [Languages](#) ▼

Testing is very important to help reduce the spread of COVID-19.

Types of COVID-19 Tests

COVID-19 tests can detect either **SARS-CoV-2**, the virus that causes COVID-19, or **antibodies** that your body makes after getting COVID-19 or after getting vaccinated.

Tests for [SARS-CoV-2](#) tell you [if you have an infection](#) at the time of the test. This type of test is called a “viral” test because it looks for viral infection. Antigen or [Nucleic Acid Amplification Tests \(NAATs\)](#) are viral tests.

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Viral Tests

A [viral test](#) tells you if you are infected with SARS-CoV-2, the virus that causes COVID-19. There are two types of viral tests: rapid tests and laboratory tests. Viral tests use samples that come from your nose or mouth. Rapid tests can be performed in minutes and can include antigen and some NAATs. Laboratory tests can take days to complete and include RT-PCR and other types of NAATs. Some test results may need confirmatory testing.

Self-tests are rapid tests that can be taken at home or anywhere, are easy to use, and produce rapid results. COVID-19 [self-tests](#) are one of many risk-reduction measures, along with vaccination, masking, and physical distancing, that protect you and others by reducing the chances of spreading COVID-19.

Antibody Tests

An [antibody test](#) (also known as a serology test) can detect antibodies to SARS-CoV-2 in your blood. **Antibodies** are proteins that your immune system makes to help fight infection and protect you from getting sick in the future.

Antibody tests should not be used to diagnose a current infection, but may indicate if you had a past infection. Antibody tests help scientists learn about how human immune systems defend against the virus, as well as learn about population-level protection.

Antibody testing is [not currently recommended](#) to determine:

- If you have a current infection.
- If you have immunity to SARS-CoV-2 following COVID-19 vaccination.
- Whether you need to get vaccinated if you are not fully vaccinated.
- Whether you need to quarantine after a known or suspected exposure to COVID-19.

You should always discuss your test results with your healthcare provider.

Testing Tools

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Coronavirus Self-Checker

A tool to help you make decisions on when to seek testing and medical care.

Get Started

About the Tool



COVID-19 Viral Testing Tool

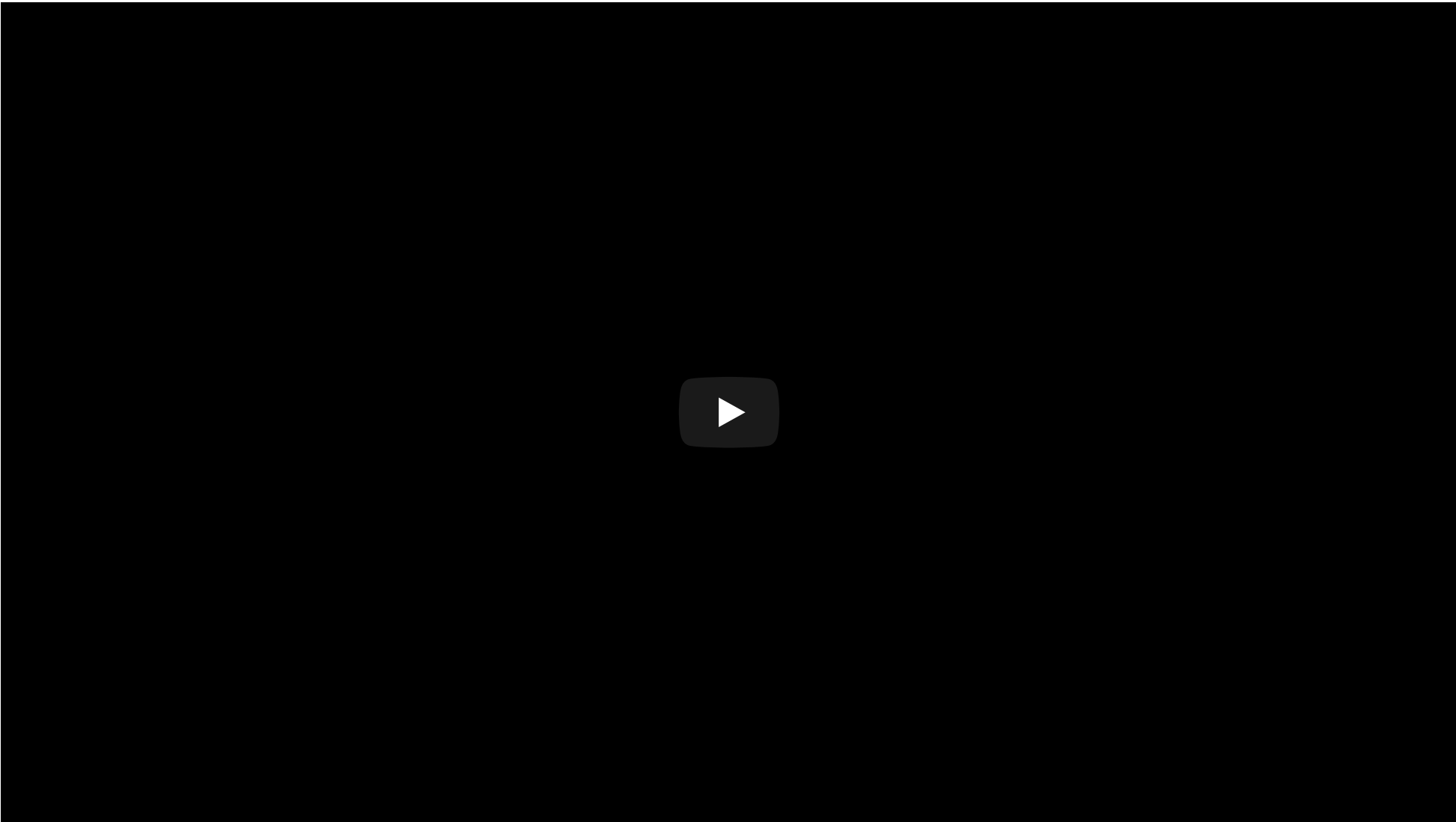
A tool to help you understand COVID-19 testing options.

Get Started

About the Tool

Video and Print Resources

Antibody Test for COVID-19



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Viral Test for COVID-19



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 [Low Resolution Video](#)

Related Pages

- › [Test for Current Infection](#)
- › [Test for Past Infection](#)



Last Updated Dec. 6, 2021

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Activities, Gatherings & Holidays	+



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COVID-19

We have the tools to
Fight Omicron



Vaccines & Booster



Masks



Testing

Updated Dec. 29, 2021

[Languages](#) ▼

CDC has updated isolation and quarantine recommendations for the public. These recommendations do not supersede state, local, tribal, or territorial laws, rules, and regulations. Read [CDC's media statement](#).

Testing is very important to help reduce the spread of COVID-19.

Types of COVID-19 Tests

COVID-19 tests can detect either **SARS-CoV-2**, the virus that causes COVID-19, or **antibodies** that your body makes after getting COVID-19 or after getting vaccinated.

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[Get Started](#)[About the Tool](#)

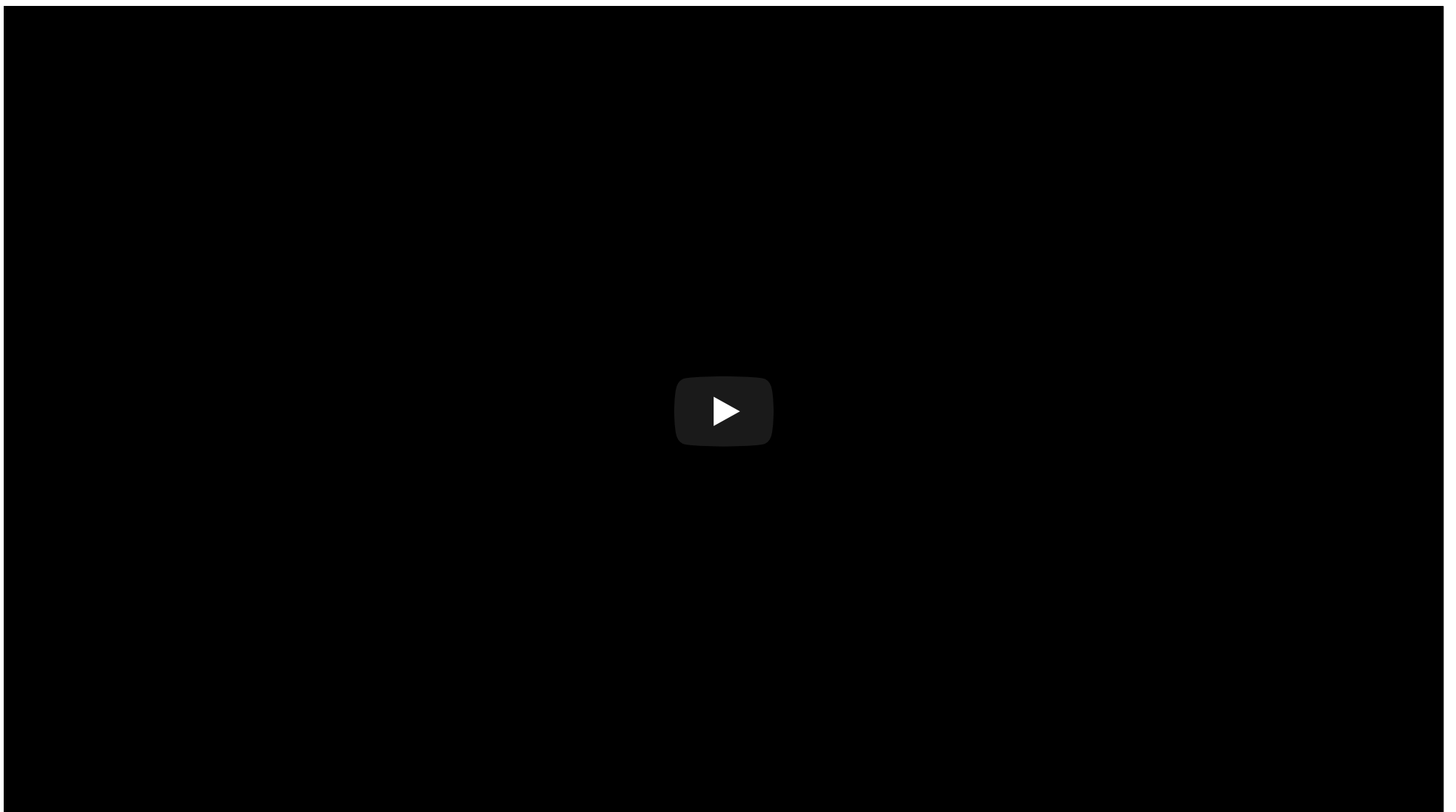
COVID-19 Viral Testing Tool

A tool to help you understand COVID-19 testing options.

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Video and Print Resources

Antibody Test for COVID-19

[View Transcript](#)[Low Resolution Video](#)

Viral Test for COVID-19



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 [COVID Testing Flowchart](#)  [JPG - 341 KB]

Need a COVID-19 Test?

Related Pages

- › [Test for Current Infection](#)
- › [Test for Past Infection](#)



Last Updated Dec. 29, 2021

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COVID-19

Updated Feb. 1, 2022 [Languages](#) ▼



Free At-Home COVID-19 Tests: [Order 4 free tests now so you have them when you need them.](#) [↗](#)

Types of COVID-19 Tests

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Testing is very important to help reduce the spread of COVID-19. You should always discuss your test results with your healthcare provider.

Viral Tests

- A [viral test](#) tells you if you are infected with [SARS-CoV-2](#), the virus that causes COVID-19, using samples that come from your nose or mouth. There are two types of viral tests: rapid tests and laboratory tests. COVID-19 testing is one of many risk-reduction measures, along with vaccination, masking, and physical distancing, that protect you and others by reducing the chances of spreading COVID-19.
- **Rapid Point-of-Care tests**, test performed or interpreted by someone other than the individual being tested, can be performed in minutes and can include antigen and some NAATs.
 - [Self-tests](#) are rapid tests that can be taken at home or anywhere, are easy to use, and produce rapid results.
- **Laboratory tests** can take days to complete and include RT-PCR and other types of NAATs.



Watch Video: [Viral Test for COVID-19 \[00:01:08\]](#) [↗](#)

Antibody Tests

An [antibody test](#) (also known as a serology test) can detect antibodies to SARS-CoV-2 in your blood. **Antibodies** are proteins that your immune system makes to help fight infection and protect you from getting sick in the future.

Antibody tests should not be used to diagnose a current infection, but they may indicate if you had a past infection. Antibody tests help learn about how human immune systems defend against the virus, as well as learn about population-level protection. If you get an antibody test after receiving a [vaccine](#), you might test positive by some (but not all) antibody tests. This depends on which type of antibody the specific test detects.

Antibody testing is [not currently recommended](#) to determine:

- If you have a current infection.
- If you have immunity to SARS-CoV-2 following COVID-19 vaccination.
- Whether you need to get a [booster](#) following COVID-19 vaccination.
- Whether you need to [quarantine](#) after a known or suspected exposure to COVID-19.

 **Watch Video:** [Antibody Test for COVID-19 \[00:01:06\]](#) 

Need a COVID-19 Test?

Reasons to Get Tested

- If you have COVID-19 symptoms
- At least 5 days after known or suspected close contact to COVID-19
- For screening (schools, workplaces, congregate settings, etc.)
- Before and after travel
- When asked by a healthcare professional or public health official

Types of Viral Tests

Laboratory Test

- Sample can either be a nasal swab or saliva
- Results usually in 1-3 days
- Results are reliable for people with and without symptoms
- No follow-up test required
- Common example: PCR test

Rapid Test

- Sample is usually a nasal swab
- Results usually in 15-30 minutes
- Results may be less reliable for people without symptoms
- Follow-up test may be required
- Common example: Antigen test

Actions After Result

If Positive Result

- [Isolate](#) for at least 5 days. Learn more about [isolation timelines and precautions](#)
- Seek a confirmatory, follow-up laboratory test if recommended by healthcare professional
- Monitor your symptoms

If Negative Result

- If [up to date on vaccines](#): return to normal activities. Wear a mask indoors in areas of high or substantial community transmission.
- If not up to date on vaccines and have symptoms or exposure: [quarantine](#) for at least 5 days.
- If not up to date on vaccines and have no symptoms or exposure: return to normal activities. Take steps to get up to date on vaccines to protect yourself and others.

 **Download Graphic:** [Need a COVID-19 Test?](#)  [1Page, 341 KB]

Need additional help? [CDC's Viral Testing Tool](#) is an online, mobile-friendly tool that asks a series of questions, and provides recommended actions and resources based on a user's responses.

Testing Tools

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[Get Started](#)

[About the Tool](#)

Print Resources

Related Pages

- › [Test for Current Infection](#)
- › [Test for Past Infection](#)



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COVID-19

COVID-19 Testing: What You Need to Know

Updated Feb. 25, 2022



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 [Watch Video: Viral Test for COVID-19 \[00:01:08\]](#)

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- Whether you need to [quarantine](#) after a known or suspected exposure to COVID-19.

 [Watch Video: Antibody Test for COVID-19 \[00:01:06\]](#)

Science at CDC

Scientific evidence and studies behind specific COVID-19 guidance and recommendations

[Science Briefs](#)

[MMWR COVID-19 Reports](#)

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If Negative Result

- If [up to date on vaccines](#): return to normal activities. Wear a mask indoors in areas where the [COVID-19 Community Level](#) is high.
- If not up to date on vaccines and have symptoms or exposure: [quarantine](#) for at least 5 days.
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Download Graphic: [Need a COVID-19 Test?](#) [1Page, 341 KB]

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Last Updated Feb. 25, 2022



COVID-19 Testing: What You Need to Know

Updated May 3, 2022



Free At-Home COVID-19 Tests: [Order 8 free tests now so you have them when you need them.](#) [↗](#)

Types of COVID-19 Tests

COVID-19 tests can detect either **SARS-CoV-2** or **biomarkers** of SARS-CoV-2, the virus that causes COVID-19, or **antibodies** that your body makes after getting COVID-19 or after getting vaccinated.

Tests for **SARS-CoV-2** tell you [if you have an infection](#) at the time of the test. This type of test is called a “viral” test because it looks for viral infection. Antigen tests, [Nucleic Acid Amplification Tests \(NAATs\)](#) and [other tests](#) are viral tests.

Tests for [antibodies](#) may tell you [if you have had a past infection](#) with the virus that causes COVID-19. Your body creates antibodies after getting infected with SARS-CoV-2 or after getting vaccinated against COVID-19. These tests are called “antibody” or “serology” tests.

Testing is very important to help reduce the spread of COVID-19. You should always discuss your test results with your healthcare provider.

Viral Tests

A [viral test](#) tells you if you are infected with **SARS-CoV-2**, the virus that causes COVID-19, using samples that come from your nose or mouth. There are two types of viral tests: rapid tests and laboratory tests. COVID-19 testing is one of many risk-reduction measures, along with vaccination, masking, and physical distancing, that protect you and others by reducing the chances of spreading COVID-19.

- **Rapid Point-of-Care tests**, test performed or interpreted by someone other than the individual being tested, can be performed in minutes and can include antigen tests, some NAATs, and [other tests](#).
 - [Self-tests](#) are rapid tests that can be taken at home or anywhere, are easy to use, and produce rapid results.
- **Laboratory tests** can take days to complete and include RT-PCR and other types of NAATs.

 Watch Video: [Viral Test for COVID-19](#) [00:01:08]

Antibody Tests

An [antibody test](#) (also known as a serology test) can detect antibodies to SARS-CoV-2 in your blood. **Antibodies** are proteins that your immune system makes to help fight infection and protect you from getting sick in the future.

Antibody tests should not be used to diagnose a current infection, but they may indicate if you had a past infection. Antibody tests help learn about how human immune systems defend against the virus, as well as learn about population-level protection. If you get an antibody test after receiving a [vaccine](#), you might test positive by some (but not all) antibody tests. This depends on which type of antibody the specific test detects.

Antibody testing is [not currently recommended](#) to determine:

- If you have a current infection.
- If you have immunity to SARS-CoV-2 following COVID-19 vaccination.
- Whether you need to get a [booster](#) following COVID-19 vaccination.
- Whether you need to [quarantine](#) after a known or suspected exposure to COVID-19.

 Watch Video: [Antibody Test for COVID-19](#) [00:01:06]

Need a COVID-19 Test?

Reasons to Get Tested

- If you have COVID-19 symptoms
- At least 5 days after known or suspected close contact to COVID-19
- For screening (schools, workplaces, congregate settings, etc.)
- Before and after travel
- When asked by a healthcare professional or public health official

Types of Viral Tests

Laboratory Test

- Sample can either be a nasal swab or saliva
- Results usually in 1-3 days
- Results are reliable for people with and without symptoms
- No follow-up test required
- Common example: PCR test

Rapid Test

- Sample is usually a nasal swab
- Results usually in 15-30 minutes
- Results may be less reliable for people without symptoms
- Follow-up test may be required
- Common example: Antigen test

Actions After Result

If Positive Result

- [Isolate](#) for at least 5 days. Learn more about [isolation timelines and precautions](#)
- Seek a confirmatory, follow-up laboratory test if recommended by healthcare professional
- Monitor your symptoms

If Negative Result

- If [up to date on vaccines](#): return to normal activities. Wear a mask indoors in areas where the [COVID-19 Community Level](#) is high.
- If not up to date on vaccines and have symptoms or exposure: [quarantine](#) for at least 5 days.
- If not up to date on vaccines and have no symptoms or exposure: return to normal activities. Take steps to get up to date on vaccines to protect yourself and others.



Download Graphic: [Need a COVID-19 Test?](#) [1Page, 341 KB]

Testing Tools

These chatbots ask a series of questions, and provide recommended actions and resources based on your responses.



Coronavirus Self-Checker

A tool to help you make decisions on when to seek testing and medical care.

[Get Started](#)

[About the Tool](#)

Need additional help? CDC's [Viral Testing Tool](#) is an online, mobile-friendly tool that asks a series of questions, and provides recommended actions and resources based on a user's responses.

Print Resources

 DO YOUR PART: GET TESTED COVID-19 You have an important role to play in stopping this pandemic. If you have symptoms, especially if you've been around someone with COVID-19, you should get tested as soon as possible. By getting tested, you protect the health of those you love and everyone around you. Encourage your friends and family to get tested if they have symptoms.  www.cdc.gov/covidtesting	 COVID-19 TESTING IF YOU ARE VACCINATED COVID-19 You did your part by getting vaccinated, but you still have an important role to play in stopping this pandemic. Even though it's rare, some people who are vaccinated still get COVID-19. By getting tested you protect the people around you, including your loved ones. Encourage your friends and family to get vaccinated. Remember, if you feel sick, get tested.  www.cdc.gov/covidtesting
Do Your Part: Get Tested	COVID-19 Testing If You Are Vaccinated
 [PDF - 426 KB, 1 Page]	 [PDF - 1 page, 129 KB]

What Your Test Results Mean

Accessible version available at <https://www.cdc.gov/media/releases/2020/s201028-covid-test-interpret.html>

If you test positive for COVID-19

TAKE STEPS TO PROTECT OTHERS REGARDLESS OF YOUR COVID-19 VACCINATION STATUS



STAY HOME.

Isolate at home for at least 10 days.
Stay in a specific room and away from other people in your home.



STAY IN TOUCH WITH YOUR DOCTOR.

Contact your doctor as soon as possible if you are an older adult or have underlying medical conditions.



GET REST AND STAY HYDRATED.

If you develop symptoms, continue to isolate for at least 10 days after symptoms began and until you do not have a fever without using medications to reduce fever.



CONTACT YOUR DOCTOR OR HEALTH DEPARTMENT ABOUT ISOLATION IF YOU

- Are severely ill or have a weakened immune system.
- Had a positive test result followed by a negative result.
- Test positive for many weeks.

If you test negative for COVID-19:

- The virus was not detected.

If you have symptoms of COVID-19:

- You may have received a false negative test result and still might have COVID-19.
- Isolate from others.

If you do not have symptoms of COVID-19 and you were exposed to a person with COVID-19:

- You are likely not infected, but you still may get sick.
- Contact your doctor about your symptoms, about follow-up testing, and how long to isolate.
- Self-quarantine for 14 days at home after your exposure.
- If you are fully vaccinated, you do not need to self-quarantine.
- Contact your doctor or local health department regarding options to reduce the length of your quarantine.

A negative test result does not mean you won't get sick later.



[cdc.gov/coronavirus](https://www.cdc.gov/coronavirus)

GOOD THINGS TO KNOW ABOUT A COVID-19 TEST | COVID-19 |

FREE

COVID-19 tests are [available at no cost nationwide](#) at health centers and select pharmacies.



EFFECTIVE

COVID-19 tests are effective at detecting a COVID-19 infection.

QUICK

Current rapid COVID-19 tests provide results in 15 minutes.



www.cdc.gov/covidtesting

What Your Test Results Mean

[PDF - 216 KB, 1 page]

Good Things to Know About A COVID-19 Test

[PDF - 55KB, 1 Page]

WHAT TO EXPECT WHEN GETTING TESTED

| COVID-19 |

Most COVID-19 tests use swabs to gather samples.

You can get your test results as quickly as 15 minutes or up to a few days, depending on the type of test.





Some testing locations may be crowded. While you are waiting to get your test and results, wear a mask and stay at least 6 feet apart from others.

Your Results

If you test NEGATIVE for COVID-19, the virus was not detected.

- You are likely not infected.
- For more information about the types of COVID-19 tests and why you might have tested negative, go to www.cdc.gov/covidtesting.



If you test POSITIVE take [steps to protect others](#) regardless of your COVID-19 vaccination status.

- Isolate from others for at least 10 days since symptoms first appeared.
- Avoid contact with other members of your household and pets.



www.cdc.gov/covidtesting

What to Expect When Getting Tested

 [PDF - 183 KB, 1 page]

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Resources

COVID-19 Testing Resources 

Science at CDC

Scientific evidence and studies behind specific COVID-19 guidance and recommendations

Science Briefs

MMWR COVID-19 Reports

Related Pages

- › Test for Current Infection
- › Test for Past Infection

Last Updated May 3, 2022



COVID-19

Updated Aug. 11, 2022 [Español](#) | [Other Languages](#)

When you get tested:

- Make sure to test at the right time
- Choose the right type of test for your circumstance
- Follow test directions as recommended by FDA

If you do not, your results may be less likely to correctly indicate whether you have COVID-19 or not.

On This Page

[When to Get Tested](#)

[Types of Tests](#)

[Choosing a COVID-19 Test](#)

[Positive Test Result](#)

[Negative Test Result](#)

[Testing for Antibodies](#)

When to Get Tested for COVID-19



Key times to get tested:

- If you have [symptoms](#), test immediately.
- If you were exposed to COVID-19 and do not have symptoms, wait at least 5 full days after your exposure before testing. If you test too early, you may be more likely to get an inaccurate result.
- If you are in certain high-risk settings, you may need to test as part of a screening testing program.
- Consider testing before contact with someone at high risk for severe COVID-19, especially if you are in an area with a medium or high COVID-19 Community Level.

For guidance on using tests to determine which mitigations are recommended as you recover from COVID-19, go to [Isolation and Precautions for People with COVID-19](#).



Get COVID-19 Tests or Treatment

[Free At-Home Tests](#) 

[Community-Based Testing Locations](#) 

[Test to Treat Locations](#) 

Types of Tests

Viral tests look for a current infection with SARS-CoV-2, the virus that causes COVID-19, by testing specimens from your nose or mouth. There are two main types of viral tests: nucleic acid amplification tests (NAATs) and antigen tests. In certain circumstances, one test type may be recommended over the other. All tests should be performed following FDA's requirements.

- **NAATs**, such as PCR-based tests, are most often performed in a laboratory. They are typically the most reliable tests for people with or without symptoms. These tests detect viral genetic material, which may stay in your body for up to 90 days after you test positive. Therefore, you should not use a NAAT if you have tested positive in the last 90 days.
- **Antigen tests*** are rapid tests which produce results in 15-30 minutes. They are less reliable than NAATs, especially for people who do not have symptoms. A single, negative antigen test result does not rule out infection. To best detect infection, a negative antigen test should be repeated at least 48 hours apart (known as serial testing). Sometimes a follow-up NAAT may be recommended to confirm an antigen test result.

***Self-tests**, or at-home tests, are usually antigen tests that can be taken anywhere without having to go to a specific testing site. Follow FDA and manufacturer's instructions, including for the number of times you may need to test. Multiple negative test results increase the confidence that you are not infected with the virus that causes COVID-19.

- You can order free self-test kits at [COVIDtests.gov](https://www.covidtests.gov)  or purchase tests online, in pharmacies, and retail stores.
- You can also visit [FDA's website](https://www.fda.gov)  to see a list of authorized tests.
- As noted in the labeling for authorized over-the-counter antigen tests: Negative results should be treated as presumptive (meaning that they are preliminary results). Negative results do not rule out SARS-CoV-2 infection and should not be used as the sole basis for treatment or patient management decisions, including infection control decisions. Please see FDA guidance on the use of at-home COVID-19 antigen tests.

About Self-Tests

Choosing a COVID-19 Test

I am in a circumstance where I should get tested and:

I have not had COVID-19 or I have not had a positive test within the past 90 days.

You may choose NAAT or antigen tests.

If you use an antigen test and your result is negative, multiple tests may be necessary.

I tested positive for COVID-19 in the last 90 days.

My first positive test result was within:

30 days or less

I have symptoms

Use antigen tests. If negative, multiple tests may be necessary.

I do not have symptoms

Testing is not recommended to detect a new infection.

My first positive test result was within:

31-90 days

I have symptoms

Use antigen tests. If negative, multiple tests may be necessary.

I do not have symptoms

Use antigen tests. If negative, multiple tests may be necessary

After a positive test result, you may continue to test positive for some time after. You may continue to test positive on antigen tests for a few weeks after your initial positive. You may continue to test positive on NAATs for up to 90 days. Reinfections can occur within 90 days, which can make it hard to know if a positive test indicates a new infection. Consider consulting a healthcare provider if you have any questions or concerns about your individual circumstances.

Interpreting Your Results

If Your COVID-19 Test is

Positive

Any positive COVID-19 test means the virus was detected and **you have an infection**.

- Isolate and take precautions including wearing a high-quality mask to protect others from getting infected.
- Tell people you had recent contact with that they [may have been exposed](#).
- Monitor your [symptoms](#). If you have any [emergency warning signs](#), seek emergency care immediately.
- Consider contacting a healthcare provider, [community health center](#) [↗](#), or pharmacy to learn about [treatment options](#) that may be available to you. Treatment must be started within several days after you first develop symptoms to be effective.
 - You are more likely to get very sick if you are an older adult or have an underlying medical condition. [Possible treatment](#) may be available for you.

If Your COVID-19 Test is

Negative

A negative COVID-19 test means the test did not detect the virus, but this **doesn't rule out that you could have an infection**. If you used an antigen test, see [FDA instructions on repeat testing](#) [↗](#).

- If you have symptoms:
 - You may have COVID-19, but tested before the virus was detectable, or you may have another illness.
 - Take general public health precautions to prevent spreading an illness to others.
 - Contact a healthcare provider if you have any questions about your test result or if your symptoms worsen.
- If you do not have symptoms, but were exposed to the virus that causes COVID-19, you should continue to take recommended steps after exposure.
- If you do not have symptoms and you have not been exposed to the virus that causes COVID-19, you may return to normal activities.
 - Continue to take steps to [protect yourself and others](#), including monitoring for symptoms. Get tested again if symptoms appear.

Need additional help? Use the [Viral Testing Tool](#) to get personalized recommendations and resources.

Testing for Antibodies

Antibody or serology tests look for antibodies in your blood that fight the virus that causes COVID-19. Antibodies are proteins created by your immune system after you have been infected or have been vaccinated against an infection. They can help protect you from infection, or severe illness if you do get infected, for a period of time afterward. How long this protection lasts is different for each disease and each person.

Antibody tests should not be used to diagnose a current infection with the virus that causes COVID-19. An antibody test may not show if you have a current infection, because it can take 1 to 3 weeks after the infection for your body to make antibodies.

Resources



Professional Resources on Testing: [Healthcare Workers](#) | [Health Departments](#) | [Labs](#)

Print Resources



- [COVID-19 Testing Resources](#)  [1 page, 59 KB]
- [Don't Delay: Test Soon and Treat Early](#)  [1 page, 361 KB]
- [How to Collect an Anterior Nasal Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing](#)  [2 pages, 372 KB]
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Last Updated Aug. 11, 2022

 Your Health

About COVID-19



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Protect Yourself & Others	+
If You Were Exposed	
If You Are Sick	+
Long COVID	+
Travel	+

Get Email Updates

To receive email updates about COVID-19, enter your email address:

[What's this?](#)

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CONTACT CDC



ABOUT CDC



POLICIES



LANGUAGE ASSISTANCE



U.S. Department of Health & Human Services
USA.gov

CDC Website Exit Disclaimer 

LANGUAGE ASSISTANCE

Español

繁體中文

Tiếng Việt

한국어

Français

Polski

Português

Italiano

Tagalog

Русский

العربية

Kreyòl Ayisyen

Deutsch

日本語

فارسی

English



COVID-19



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Updated Sept. 28, 2022 [Español](#) | [Other Languages](#)

When you get tested:

- Make sure to test at the right time
- Choose the right type of test for your circumstance
- Follow test directions as recommended by FDA

If you do not, your results may be less likely to correctly indicate whether you have COVID-19 or not.

On This Page

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[Types of Tests](#)

[Choosing a COVID-19 Test](#)

[Positive Test Result](#)

[Negative Test Result](#)

[Testing for Antibodies](#)

When to Get Tested for COVID-19



Key times to get tested:

- If you have [symptoms](#), test immediately.
- If you were exposed to COVID-19 and do not have symptoms, wait at least 5 full days after your exposure before testing. If you test too early, you may be more likely to get an inaccurate result.
- If you are in certain high-risk settings, you may need to test as part of a screening testing program.
- Consider testing before contact with someone at high risk for severe COVID-19, especially if you are in an area with a medium or high COVID-19 Community Level.

For guidance on using tests to determine which mitigations are recommended as you recover from COVID-19, go to [Isolation and Precautions for People with COVID-19](#).

COVID-19 Tests or Treatment

[Free At-Home Tests](#)[Testing Locator](#)[Treatment Locator](#)

Types of Tests

Viral tests look for a current infection with SARS-CoV-2, the virus that causes COVID-19, by testing specimens from your nose or mouth. There are two main types of viral tests: nucleic acid amplification tests (NAATs) and antigen tests. In certain circumstances, one test type may be recommended over the other. All tests should be performed following FDA's requirements.

- **NAATs**, such as PCR-based tests, are most often performed in a laboratory. They are typically the most reliable tests for people with or without symptoms. These tests detect viral genetic material, which may stay in your body for up to 90 days after you test positive. Therefore, you should not use a NAAT if you have tested positive in the last 90 days.
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***Self-tests**, or at-home tests, are usually antigen tests that can be taken anywhere without having to go to a specific testing site. Follow FDA and manufacturer's instructions, including for the number of times you may need to test. Multiple negative test results increase the confidence that you are not infected with the virus that causes COVID-19.

- You can order free self-test kits at [COVIDtests.gov](https://www.covidtests.gov)  or purchase tests online, in pharmacies, and retail stores.
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About Self-Tests

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I have symptoms

Use antigen tests. If negative, multiple tests may be necessary.

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Testing is not recommended to detect a new infection.

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Use antigen tests. If negative, multiple tests may be necessary

After a positive test result, you may continue to test positive for some time after. You may continue to test positive on antigen tests for a few weeks after your initial positive. You may continue to test positive on NAATs for up to 90 days. Reinfections can occur within 90 days, which can make it hard to know if a positive test indicates a new infection. Consider consulting a healthcare provider if you have any questions or concerns about your individual circumstances.

Interpreting Your Results

If Your COVID-19 Test is

Positive

Any positive COVID-19 test means the virus was detected and **you have an infection**.

- Isolate and take precautions including wearing a high-quality mask to protect others from getting infected.
- Tell people you had recent contact with that they [may have been exposed](#).
- Monitor your [symptoms](#). If you have any [emergency warning signs](#), seek emergency care immediately.
- Consider contacting a healthcare provider, [community health center](#) [↗](#), or pharmacy to learn about [treatment options](#) that may be available to you. Treatment must be started within several days after you first develop symptoms to be effective.
 - You are more likely to get very sick if you are an older adult or have an underlying medical condition. [Possible treatment](#) may be available for you.

If Your COVID-19 Test is

Negative

A negative COVID-19 test means the test did not detect the virus, but this **doesn't rule out that you could have an infection**. If you used an antigen test, see [FDA instructions on repeat testing](#) [↗](#).

- If you have symptoms:
 - You may have COVID-19, but tested before the virus was detectable, or you may have another illness.
 - Take general public health precautions to prevent spreading an illness to others.
 - Contact a healthcare provider if you have any questions about your test result or if your symptoms worsen.

- If you do not have symptoms, but were exposed to the virus that causes COVID-19, you should continue to take recommended steps after exposure.
- If you do not have symptoms and you have not been exposed to the virus that causes COVID-19, you may return to normal activities.
 - Continue to take steps to [protect yourself and others](#), including monitoring for symptoms. Get tested again if symptoms appear.

Need additional help with COVID-19 testing? [WhenToTest.org](https://www.cdc.gov/when-to-test)  is an online, mobile-friendly tool that helps you make decisions about COVID-19 testing.

Testing for Antibodies

Antibody or serology tests look for antibodies in your blood that fight the virus that causes COVID-19. Antibodies are proteins created by your immune system after you have been infected or have been vaccinated against an infection. They can help protect you from infection, or severe illness if you do get infected, for a period of time afterward. How long this protection lasts is different for each disease and each person.

Antibody tests should not be used to diagnose a current infection with the virus that causes COVID-19. An antibody test may not show if you have a current infection, because it can take 1 to 3 weeks after the infection for your body to make antibodies.

Science at CDC

Scientific evidence and studies behind specific COVID-19 guidance and recommendations

MMWR: [Minimizing the impact of COVID-19 on Individual persons, Communities, and Health Care Systems](#)



Difference Between Flu and COVID-19

Influenza (Flu) and COVID-19 are both contagious respiratory illnesses, but they are caused by different viruses. COVID-19 is caused by infection with a coronavirus named SARS-CoV-2, and flu is caused by infection with influenza viruses. You cannot tell the difference between flu and COVID-19 by symptoms alone because some of the symptoms are the same. Some PCR tests can differentiate between flu and COVID-19 at the same time. If one of these tests is not available, many [testing locations](#) provide flu and COVID-19 tests separately. Talk to a healthcare provider about getting tested for both flu and COVID-19 if you have symptoms.

[Learn more](#)

Resources



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Print Resources

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Last Updated Sept. 28, 2022



Your Health

About COVID-19



Symptoms

Testing



Self-Testing

Understanding Your Risk



COVID-19 by County

Prevention



If You Were Exposed

If You Are Sick



Long COVID



Travel



Get Email Updates

To receive email updates about COVID-19, enter your email address:

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LANGUAGES



COVID-19 Web Archive

U.S. Department of Health & Human Services

USA.gov



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Updated May 11, 2023

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There are two main types of viral tests:

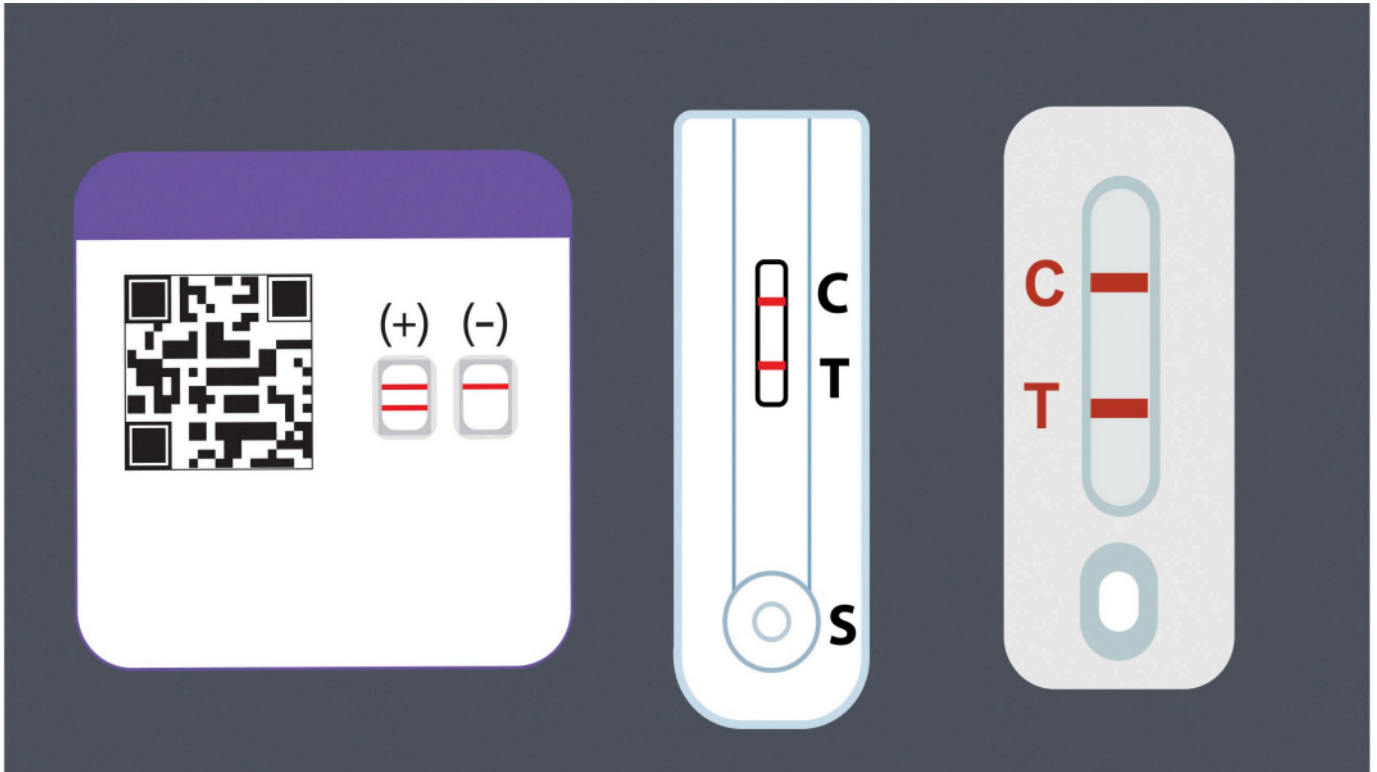
- Polymerase Chain Reaction (PCR) tests
- Antigen tests

PCR Tests



PCR tests are the “gold standard” for COVID-19 tests. They are a type of nucleic acid amplification test (NAAT), which are more likely to detect the virus than antigen tests. Your sample will usually be taken by a healthcare provider and transported to a laboratory for testing. It may take up to 3 days to receive results.

Antigen Tests



Antigen tests* are rapid tests that usually produce results in 15-30 minutes. Positive results are very accurate and reliable. However, in general, antigen tests are less likely to detect the virus than PCR tests, especially when [symptoms](#) are not present. Therefore, a single negative antigen test cannot rule out infection. To be confident you do not have COVID-19, [FDA recommends](#) ☒ 2 negative antigen tests for individuals with symptoms or 3 antigen tests for those without symptoms, performed 48 hours apart. A single PCR test can be used to confirm an antigen test result.

*Self-tests, or at-home tests, are antigen tests that can be taken anywhere without having to go to a specific testing site. Read self-test package inserts thoroughly and follow the instructions closely when performing the test.

Read more: [Self-Testing At Home or Anywhere](#)

When to Get Tested for COVID-19



Key times to get tested:

If you have symptoms, test immediately.

- If you are only going to take a single test, a PCR test will provide a more reliable negative test result.
- If you use an antigen test, a positive result is reliable, but a negative test is not always accurate.
- If your antigen test is negative, take another antigen test after 48 hours **or** take a PCR test as soon as you can.

If you do not have symptoms but have been exposed to COVID-19, wait at least 5 full days after your exposure before taking a test.

- If you are only going to take a single test, a PCR test will provide a more reliable negative test result.
- If you use an antigen test, a positive result is reliable, but a negative test is not always accurate.
- If your antigen test is negative, take another antigen test after 48 hours **or** take a PCR test as soon as you can.
- If your second antigen test is also negative, wait another 48 hours and test a third time.

Testing can be helpful even when you don't have symptoms or a recent exposure to COVID-19, such as before an event or visiting someone at higher risk. Test as close to the time of the event as possible (at least within 1-2 days) to help you make informed decisions about your health and your risk of spreading COVID-19 to others. If you use an antigen test, follow recommendations for repeat testing to be confident in a negative result. Additionally, [some places](#) may test people without symptoms or a recent exposure to help keep COVID-19 from spreading to others, especially those who are at [higher risk for severe illness](#).

Choosing a COVID-19 Test

I am in a circumstance where I should get tested and:

I have not had COVID-19 or I have not had a positive test within the past 90 days.

You may choose a PCR or antigen test.

If you use an antigen test and your result is negative, repeat testing following [FDA recommendations](#).

I tested positive for COVID-19 in the last 90 days.

My first positive test result was within:

30 days or less

I have symptoms

Use an antigen test. Repeat negative tests following [FDA recommendations](#).

I do not have symptoms

Testing is not recommended to detect a new infection.

My first positive test result was within:

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I do not have symptoms

Use an antigen test. Repeat negative tests following [FDA recommendations](#).

After a positive test result, you may continue to test positive for some time. Some tests, especially PCR tests, may continue to show a positive result for up to 90 days. [Reinfections](#) can occur within 90 days, which can make it hard to know if a positive test indicates a new infection. Consider consulting a healthcare provider if you have any questions or concerns about your circumstances.

Getting a COVID-19 Test

Buy self-tests (at-home tests)

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Go to a testing location

- Visit a [community-based testing location](#) , such as a pharmacy or [health center](#)  near you. These locations may offer PCR or antigen tests, and provide low- or no-cost testing for everyone, including people without insurance. Free PCR or antigen tests may also be available through your [local health department](#).
- Talk to a doctor or healthcare provider about other testing options that may be available to you.
- If you are a person with a disability, the [Disability Information and Access Line](#)  can help you access a test or find a test location.

Interpreting Your Results

If Your COVID-19 Test Is

Positive

Any positive COVID-19 test means the virus was detected and **you have or recently had an infection**.

- [Isolate](#) and take precautions, including wearing a [high-quality mask or respirator](#), to protect others around you from getting infected.
- Tell people you had recent contact with that they [may have been exposed](#).
- Monitor your [symptoms](#). If you have any [emergency warning signs](#), seek emergency care immediately.
- Contact a healthcare provider, [community health center](#) , or pharmacy to learn about [treatment options](#) that may be available to you. Treatment must be started within the first few days to be effective.
 - You are more likely to get very sick if you are an older adult or have an underlying medical condition. [Treatment](#) is available. Talk with your healthcare provider to determine what is the best option for you.

If Your COVID-19 Test Is

Negative

A negative COVID-19 test means the test did not detect the virus, but this **doesn't rule out that you could have an infection**. If you used an antigen test, follow [FDA recommendations for repeat testing](#) .

- If you have symptoms:
 - You may have COVID-19 but tested before the virus was detectable.
 - Consider that you may have another viral infection or illness that you need to get tested for. For many diseases, including [flu](#), early diagnosis and prompt treatment is very important for preventing severe illness.
 - Take [everyday preventive actions](#) to prevent spreading an illness to others.
 - Contact a healthcare provider if you have any questions about your test result or if your symptoms worsen.
- If you do not have symptoms but were [exposed](#) to the virus that causes COVID-19, you should continue to take [recommended steps after exposure](#).

- If you do not have symptoms and have not been exposed to the virus that causes COVID-19, you may return to normal activities.
 - Continue to take steps to [protect yourself and others](#), including monitoring for symptoms. Get tested again if symptoms appear.

Testing for Antibodies

Antibody tests detect antibodies that your body makes to fight the virus that causes COVID-19. [Antibody tests](#) should never be used to diagnose a current infection with the virus that causes COVID-19. An antibody test may not show if you have a current infection, because it can take 1 to 3 weeks after the infection for your body to make antibodies. Antibody tests can be used for [public health surveillance](#) or to test for [conditions](#) associated with COVID-19.



Testing Resources for Healthcare Professionals: [Healthcare Workers](#) | [Health Departments](#) | [Labs](#)

Last Updated May 11, 2023



COVID-19 Home

This page has content that may be inconsistent with new [CDC Respiratory Virus Guidance](#). The content of this page will be updated soon.

COVID-19 Testing: What You Need to Know

Updated Sept. 25, 2023

When you get tested:

- Make sure to test at the right time
- Choose the right type of test for your circumstance
- Follow test directions as recommended by FDA

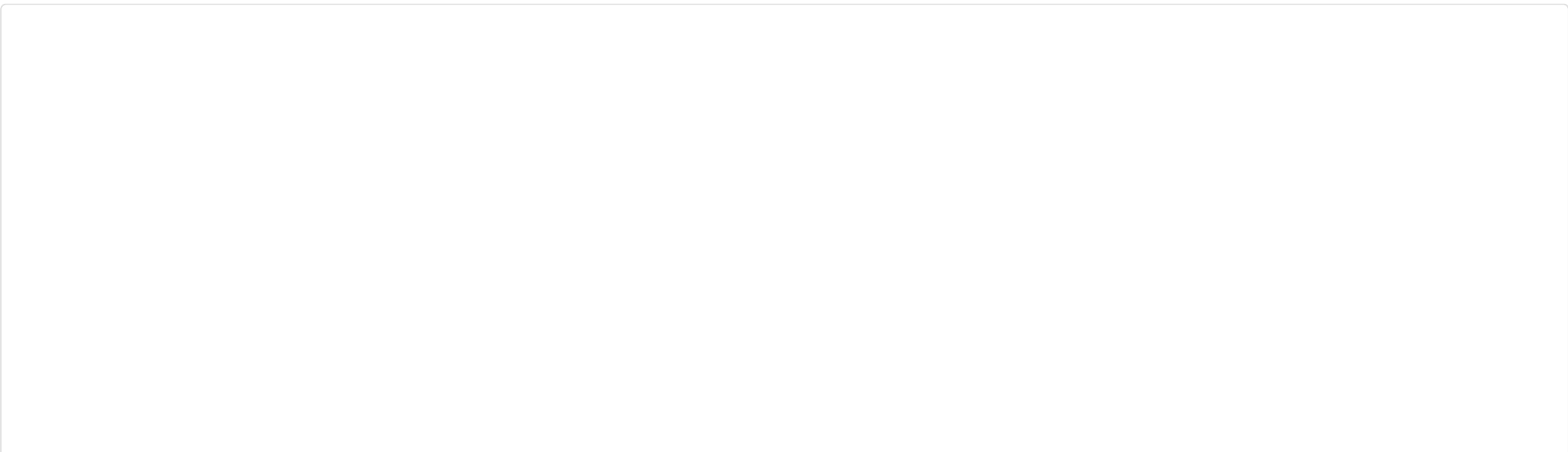
If you do not, your results may be less likely to correctly indicate whether you have COVID-19 or not.

Types of Tests

Viral tests look for a current infection with SARS-CoV-2, the virus that causes COVID-19, by testing specimens from your nose or mouth. All tests should be performed following FDA's requirements.

There are two main types of viral tests:

- Polymerase Chain Reaction (PCR) tests
- Antigen tests

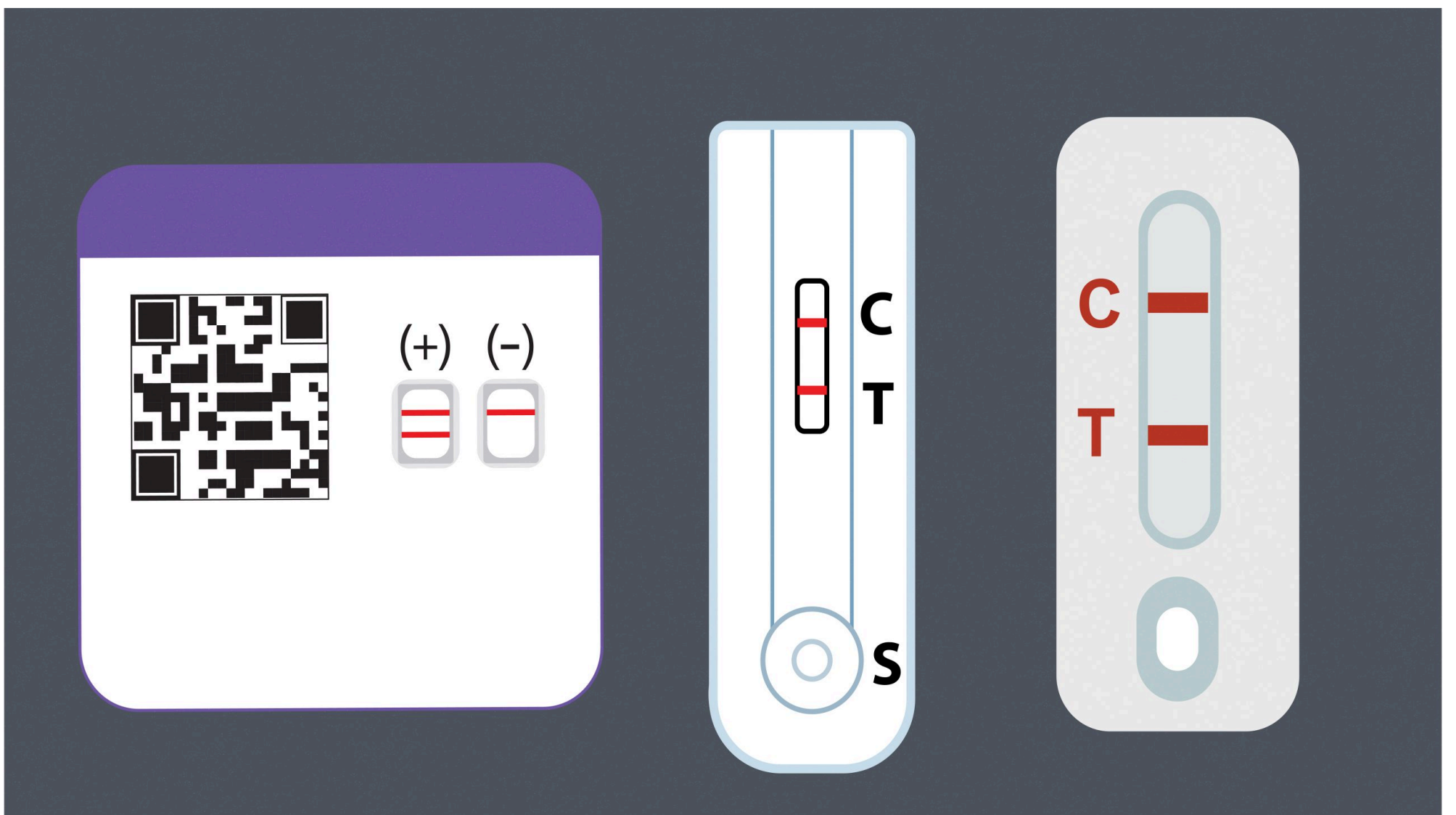


PCR Tests



PCR tests are the “gold standard” for COVID-19 tests. They are a type of nucleic acid amplification test (NAAT), which are more likely to detect the virus than antigen tests. Your sample will usually be taken by a healthcare provider and transported to a laboratory for testing. It may take up to 3 days to receive results.

Antigen Tests



Antigen tests* are rapid tests that usually produce results in 15-30 minutes. Positive results are very accurate and reliable. However, in general, antigen tests are less likely to detect the virus than PCR tests, especially when [symptoms](#) are not present. Therefore, a single negative antigen test cannot rule out infection. To be confident you do not have COVID-19, [FDA](#)

[recommends](#)  2 negative antigen tests for individuals with symptoms or 3 antigen tests for those without symptoms, performed 48 hours apart. A single PCR test can be used to confirm an antigen test result.

*Self-tests, or at-home tests, are antigen tests that can be taken anywhere without having to go to a specific testing site. Read self-test package inserts thoroughly and follow the instructions closely when performing the test.

Read more: [Self-Testing At Home or Anywhere](#)

When to Get Tested for COVID-19



Key times to get tested:

If you have symptoms, test immediately.

- If you are only going to take a single test, a PCR test will provide a more reliable negative test result.
- If you use an antigen test, a positive result is reliable, but a negative test is not always accurate.
- If your antigen test is negative, take another antigen test after 48 hours **or** take a PCR test as soon as you can.

If you do not have symptoms but have been exposed to COVID-19, wait at least 5 full days after your exposure before taking a test.

- If you are only going to take a single test, a PCR test will provide a more reliable negative test result.
- If you use an antigen test, a positive result is reliable, but a negative test is not always accurate.
- If your antigen test is negative, take another antigen test after 48 hours **or** take a PCR test as soon as you can.
- If your second antigen test is also negative, wait another 48 hours and test a third time.

Testing can be helpful even when you don't have symptoms or a recent exposure to COVID-19, such as before an event or visiting someone at higher risk. Test as close to the time of the event as possible (at least within 1-2 days) to help you make informed decisions about your health and your risk of spreading COVID-19 to others. If you use an antigen test, follow recommendations for repeat testing to be confident in a negative result. Additionally, some places may test people without symptoms or a recent exposure to help keep COVID-19 from spreading to others, especially those who are at [higher risk for severe illness](#).

Choosing a COVID-19 Test

I am in a circumstance where I should get tested and:

I have not had COVID-19 or I have not had a positive test within the past 90 days.

You may choose a PCR or antigen test.

If you use an antigen test and your result is negative, repeat testing following [FDA recommendations](#) .

I tested positive for COVID-19 in the last 90 days.

My first positive test result was within:
30 days or less

I have symptoms

Use an antigen test. Repeat negative tests following [FDA recommendations](#) .

I do not have symptoms

Testing is not recommended to detect a new infection.

My first positive test result was within:
31-90 days

I have symptoms

Use an antigen test. Repeat negative tests following [FDA recommendations](#) .

I do not have symptoms

Use an antigen test. Repeat negative tests following [FDA recommendations](#) .

After a positive test result, you may continue to test positive for some time. Some tests, especially PCR tests, may continue to show a positive result for up to 90 days. [Reinfections](#) can occur within 90 days, which can make it hard to know if a positive test indicates a new infection. Consider consulting a healthcare provider if you have any questions or concerns about your circumstances.

Getting a COVID-19 Test

Buy self-tests (at-home tests)

Buy [self-tests \(at-home tests\)](#) online or in pharmacies and retail stores. Private health insurance may reimburse the cost of purchasing self-tests. Visit [FDA's website](#) for a list of authorized tests. Self-tests are antigen tests.

Go to a testing location

- Visit a [community-based testing location](#), such as a pharmacy or [health center](#) near you. These locations may offer PCR or antigen tests, and provide low- or no-cost testing for everyone, including people without insurance. Free PCR or antigen tests may also be available through your [local health department](#).
- Talk to a doctor or healthcare provider about other testing options that may be available to you.
- If you are a person with a disability, the [Disability Information and Access Line](#) can help you access a test or find a test location.

Interpreting Your Results

If Your COVID-19 Test Is
Positive

Any positive COVID-19 test means the virus was detected and **you have or recently had an infection.**

- [Isolate](#) and take precautions, including wearing a [high-quality mask or respirator](#), to protect others around you from getting infected.

- Tell people you had recent contact with that they [may have been exposed](#).
- Monitor your [symptoms](#). If you have any [emergency warning signs](#), seek emergency care immediately.
- Contact a healthcare provider, [community health center](#) [↗](#), or pharmacy to learn about [treatment options](#) that may be available to you. Treatment must be started within the first few days to be effective.
 - You are more likely to get very sick if you are an older adult or have an underlying medical condition. [Treatment](#) is available. Talk with your healthcare provider to determine what is the best option for you.

If Your COVID-19 Test Is

Negative

A negative COVID-19 test means the test did not detect the virus, but this **doesn't rule out that you could have an infection**. If you used an antigen test, follow [FDA recommendations for repeat testing](#) [↗](#).

- If you have symptoms:
 - You may have COVID-19 but tested before the virus was detectable.
 - Consider that you may have another viral infection or illness that you need to get tested for. For many diseases, including [flu](#), early diagnosis and prompt treatment is very important for preventing severe illness.
 - Take [everyday preventive actions](#) to prevent spreading an illness to others.
 - Contact a healthcare provider if you have any questions about your test result or if your symptoms worsen.
- If you do not have symptoms but were [exposed](#) to the virus that causes COVID-19, you should continue to take [recommended steps after exposure](#).
- If you do not have symptoms and have not been exposed to the virus that causes COVID-19, you may return to normal activities.
 - Continue to take steps to [protect yourself and others](#), including monitoring for symptoms. Get tested again if symptoms appear.

Testing for Antibodies

Antibody tests detect antibodies that your body makes to fight the virus that causes COVID-19. [Antibody tests](#) should never be used to diagnose a current infection with the virus that causes COVID-19. An antibody test may not show if you have a current infection, because it can take 1 to 3 weeks after the infection for your body to make antibodies. Antibody tests can be used for [public health surveillance](#) or to test for [conditions](#) associated with COVID-19.



Testing Resources for Healthcare Professionals: [Healthcare Workers](#) | [Health Departments](#) | [Labs](#)

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Last Updated Sept. 25, 2023



COVID-19

COVID-19 Testing: What You Need to Know

Updated May 2, 2024

COVID-19 testing can help you know if you have COVID-19 so you can decide what to do next, like getting [treatment](#) to reduce your risk of severe illness and [taking steps](#) to lower your chances of spreading the virus to others.

When you get tested:

- Choose the right type of test for your circumstance
- For antigen tests, follow test directions as recommended by FDA and the test manufacturer

If you do not, your results may be less likely to correctly indicate whether you have COVID-19 or not.

Types of Tests

Viral tests look for a current infection with SARS-CoV-2, the virus that causes COVID-19, by testing specimens from your nose or mouth.

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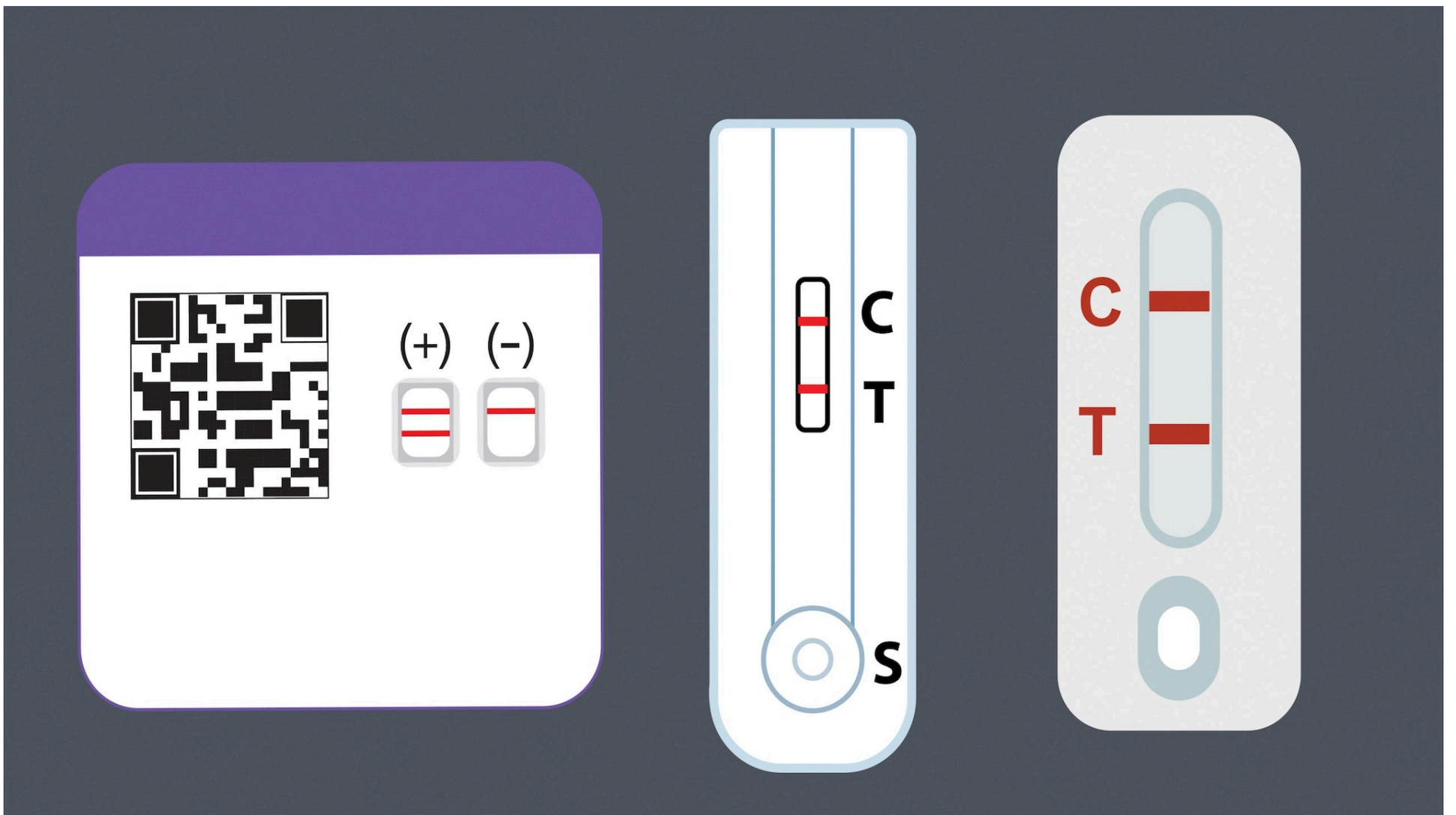


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PCR tests are the “gold standard” for COVID-19 tests. They are a type of nucleic acid amplification test (NAAT), which are more likely to detect the virus than antigen tests. Your sample will usually be taken by a healthcare provider and transported to a laboratory for testing. It may take up to 3 days to receive results.

Antigen Tests



Antigen tests* are rapid tests that usually produce results in 15-30 minutes. Positive results are accurate and reliable. However, in general, antigen tests are less likely to detect the virus than PCR tests, especially when [symptoms](#) are not present. Therefore, a single negative antigen test cannot rule out infection. To be confident you do not have COVID-19, [FDA recommends](#) [2](#) negative antigen tests for individuals with symptoms or 3 antigen tests for those without symptoms, performed 48 hours apart. A single PCR test can be used to confirm an antigen test result.

*Self-tests, or at-home tests, are antigen tests that can be taken anywhere without having to go to a specific testing site. Read self-test package inserts thoroughly and follow the instructions closely when performing the test.

Choosing a COVID-19 Test

I want to get tested and:

I have not had COVID-19 or I have not had a positive test within the past 90 days.

You may choose a PCR or antigen test.

If you use an antigen test and your result is negative, repeat testing following [FDA recommendations](#) .

I tested positive for COVID-19 in the last 90 days.

My first positive test result was within:

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If Your COVID-19 Test Is

Positive

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- Take steps to [prevent spreading](#) COVID-19.
- Monitor your [symptoms](#). If you have any [emergency warning signs](#), seek emergency care immediately.
- Seek health care right away for [treatment](#) if you have [risk factors](#) for severe illness. Treatment may be an option to make your symptoms less severe and shorten the time you are sick. Treatment needs to be started within a few days of when your symptoms begin.

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Negative

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Last Updated May 2, 2024

The Wayback Machine - <https://web.archive.org/web/20240620173637/https://www.cdc.gov/coronavirus/2019-ncov/sympto...>

 An official website of the United States government [Here's how you know](#) ▾



COVID-19

COVID-19 Testing: What You Need to Know

Updated May 2, 2024

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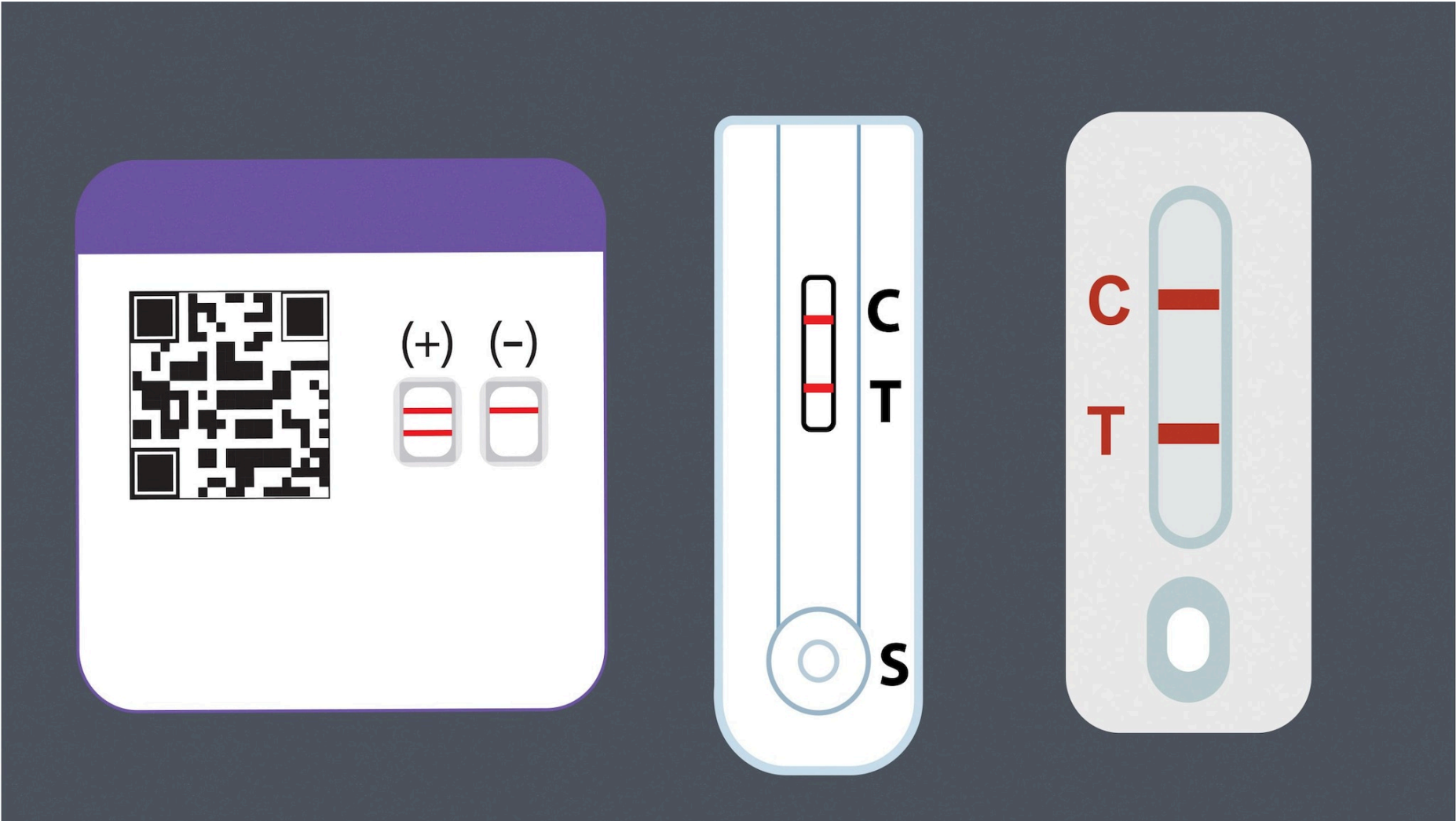


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Interpreting Your Results

If Your COVID-19 Test Is Positive

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If Your COVID-19 Test Is Negative

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- If you have symptoms:
 - You may have COVID-19 but tested before the virus was detectable.
 - You may have another viral infection or illness.
 - [Take actions to help protect yourself and others](#) from health risks caused by respiratory viruses.
 - Contact a healthcare provider if you have any questions about your test result.

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